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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uz6twWpcQsU
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:00] like it's helping people learn different ways. Is there a way through this though? I feel like this always gets like, everybody gets on one side or the other, not here in this conversation, but just out the dialogue you hear. And isn't it both? It's, we need to transparency.

[00:00:15] We need more transparency. We need more accountability. And I mean, some of the language in here is important. Don't always communicate clearly with parents. They don't, especially about things like student learning. And so all that, like, I think that's great that that's in here. And then we also need to support teachers more. And I feel like that's where it breaks down. got the parent people you got the support teachers and i would suggest i i'm sure not everybody will agree that we wouldn't be in like the temperature level around some of the issues would not be nearly as high if teachers have been better supported and not left to sort of freelance on really complicated uh really complicated topics and so like there's a big piece here and that like those

[00:00:50] two things and and it's a both and we don't need to choose between better parental engagement involving parents more making sure parents have the transparency uh into things uh that they should have and also supporting teachers more and i think both both parents and teachers are a little frustrated

right now and so that's like a good place to sort of enter the conversation so uh to pam tammy's i would love to see some language and maybe if you can come up with something that

[00:01:26] we could look at because we're this is on the agenda again tomorrow so you've got a chance tonight thank you please yeah i think i do think that there's a means by which to incorporate both because i will say i i was at my child's school yesterday talking about we were doing an ib review and as i was doing the parent perspective and i think one of the things that i took away from that

[00:02:01] is regardless of the school there are so many technological pieces these days to what's going on in a school so a teacher uses this platform or that platform and i i am this is my field and i even feel left out of the understanding of all of these different platforms that i'm supposed to engage on what my child is doing every day and so i do think there's a means by which schools do need to provide parents the opportunity to have some kind of actually really training like

[00:02:38] Is there support available to teach parents how to use Google Classroom, how to use this or how to use that? And so I think there's an involvement piece there too. And we also have to realize not everybody has easy access to technology when we're supporting all of these school-based technological means.

[00:03:06] It's just not always there. So that point too. So the training is important. I can see that being the word, but there's also another piece to it. Yeah, I'm happy to take all of this in and try to finesse it.

[00:03:25] We'll say, you know, the first draft was much more prescriptive as to this. The first draft said we must provide training to parents, and now we're encouraging local school revisions to do it if you go back and through the evolution of this. You know, one of the reasons for that change is, you know, my constant concern about what role of the board is versus the role of the locals uh and wondering how much of this you know belongs in our report you know i understand that uh there has been that there is a desire to see a paragraph dealing with parental involvement in education and i mean it is clear on the research

[00:04:04] that parental involvement or engagement sorry i probably keep using the wrong words there uh you you know, can enhance outcomes. So I get that piece. I am not sure how much, and I certainly think the board ought to recognize the role and that we as a board on those matters that come before the board ought to communicate clearly. Things like the school data, quality profiles ought to be, you know, clearly communicated, et cetera. I personally, but I, you know, I didn't take it out in the drafting because it was important that we see what other folks wanted,

[00:04:44] you know, would be quite comfortable pairing this down to basically those areas of responsibility that are the boards as opposed to that really fall upon the locals. I mean, even, you know, we have no capability of allowing the time and space for parents and teachers to meaningfully engage.

[00:05:04] It's just not in our purview at this point. It's a local operational issue. And, you know, it's a part of the things you mentioned, interestingly enough, are also not sort of and i'm not suggesting it was wrong to mention them but the interaction between parents and the locals the local divisions is much more significant than the interaction between parents and us at you know the sort of systemic level that's that was my point not that your point was wrong or anything so uh like i said when i first saw it in the mandate of training i said yeah let's

[00:05:40] just pull this and then after discussion with emily we said well we'll move it down you know a notch from mandatory because we don't have control over that to sort of you know i guess aspirational and

now as i listen to the discussion i wonder you know should we stay within our lane even more here or not that is not to take out the section entirely but to take out those portions of the section that deal with items that are just not us i think that's an interesting question but and i also think that the idea of elevating when i read this report so much of it speaks to

[00:06:17] the house is on fire there are things we need to do to address it and so for me focusing on engagement and engagement at the angle at the level that gets to how the house is not so much on fire which speaks to what am i being provided as a parent in support of my child's you know um education and i think the board's role in in elevating that we have to be concerned about that from that particular angle is the place I was going with this so that plays a little

[00:06:53] bit to pairing without sort of delving into other aspects of the issue that that may be more locally determined but the idea of of children doing better does require parents to be engaged in understanding are they making the kind of progress that I mean while I wasn't involved in pta when i go to conferences i'm really honing in on how are things going are there things i could be doing that is the moment that is the space um and so to the extent that

[00:07:31] educators feel like they can use those spaces to really help support that that's to the good so yeah i'm maybe narrowing would be helpful without taking away from all of the other relevant points that were made so perhaps we are kind of getting to that because i was thinking about the same thing during um jenna's presentation one of the things that i remember is i had some teachers that really did a good job of explaining what the pals assessment was to my child into the larger

[00:08:09] her larger um achievement and goals that were set and then i had others that just simply sent the paper home never told me about what that meant and so perhaps we're getting at that goal by directing things like um you know the literacy act to add more of those opportunities within professional development to support teachers in really encouraging you know that open conversation about what what do these assessments mean how what is it what are the impacts on your students

[00:08:46] overall achievement in their growth from assessment to assessment you know we need to explain to parents that they can be an active part of the the growth of their child by setting specific i mean i had some teachers that gave goals out of how we progress to the next level and then i again had teachers that just passed me the paper and said or sent it home in the folder well if i'm a parent that knows nothing about that what does this mean to me how do i help my my child do any better or do i even know that this is good or bad or whatever so i do think that there are some

[00:09:26] you know we can tie this to some of those opportunities within the work that we are doing and supporting that progress of involvement positively are we comfortable like as a statement into the i do think an area for the board mr president that we could especially some of the conversations we're going to have just later this afternoon like that it is an expectation and we need to do our part to support this with good systems and so forth it's our expectation you're going to communicate forthrightly and clearly with parents and we do have some divisions

[00:10:05] right now that i would respectfully suggest are not doing that so you know you're hearing there's some nape denial out there that it's not a problem and you know this kind of stuff and i do think like it's useful we want parents to be engaged we've got a level with them and that's not happening consistently and in a really high quality way and we need to i think set an expectation for that and then support that uh through our own policies and what we do so how are we going to

[00:10:33] get from here to this paragraph being redone okay there you go thank you we'll address it tomorrow thank you thank you dr man maybe we can circulate the suggestions and maybe we can go online and edit this so it's not yeah we can either yeah we can either dr man i think we'll get me a little some language tonight or in the morning and i'll be sure to have copies printed for you all to take

[00:11:08] a look at thank you okay thank you miss halter thank you thank you uh uh uh both of you i think you and everybody who's been involved in redrafting this emily and uh uh mr president and others thanks for all the good work it's it's a lot of work and incorporating the recent jlark report etc we've done a lot and it's very exciting um uh i do have several uh things to raise the

[00:11:40] first is in the uh the first two are in the um uh there's a section and i and i will say i'm sorry - Sorry to say I'm working from the penultimate draft. You sent us a corrected version this morning and I've glanced at it, but my-- - It wasn't, it was not mass, the version that I sent this morning was not massive changes, it was just incorporating a few additional comments that President Gecker had sent.

[00:12:06] - Right, right, but one of them does affect what I'm, so I may be quoting a little bit my language from the last draft, but there is a section at the end of the executive summary that talks about things we're gonna do next. - We'll need to get that updated.

[00:12:23] - Yeah, and well, but that was changed this morning, right? - Yes, so that was some language that was changed this morning. - And I do have two suggested further changes on that. And the first is that the first bullet says that things we're gonna be working on is separating the legal compliance of school accreditation from school accountability in order to increase transparency.

[00:12:44] I would like to add the word exploring because I don't think we are yet at the point of committing to that. so i would just put the word exploring before the word separating and then i would also add additional bullet for actions to address teacher shortages within the board's purview because i think that's the most important thing we're looking at everything we need to do should be looked through a lens of our teacher shortage crisis and so i would propose adding those two changes to that section if anybody wants should i pause on that if there's any discussion on that

[00:13:22] and then i've got some in other sections mistake i was trying to incorporate executive summary that you know hit the highlights um and so we did take this piece out of the text of the report and so do we still want to include that in the executive summary i think we probably wouldn't but certainly can add oh i thought it was in the oh it came out of the not an executive summer if it comes out all together i'm okay with that but i do think

[00:14:00] certainly information could be added um in here about the boards taking action within its purview to address the teacher shortage i mean that is something that is talked about throughout the report just the crisis that we're in and so that's something i'm happy to add in at the appropriate place in the report so i'll move on my next one has to do with the teacher the list um question i

[00:14:26] raised earlier i am again i'm on the penultimate draft but i will tell you in just a second uh it is on mine says five of thirty if i'm in the right spot and it's uh well it's very close to the beginning of the condition of and needs of public education in virginia that we uh there's a

[00:15:02] paragraph after there's some italicized indented section and then after that there's a paragraph it starts despite increases in education funding and then it goes on to talk about the reading specialist prescription and what happened with vla i i am not yet clear whether what happened with vla uh how does

that compare did that did the vla reading specialist positions meet our soq prescriptions they were differently worded they're different numbers and i guess in some cases they may and in others they won't right i thought the vla is what one to 550 yes one to 550 but only

[00:15:41] for k3 it is only for k3 and the board's prescription was related to k5 well and the board's prescription was really based upon a percentage of third graders failing times the enrollment for k uh five so and so it also had though a ratio of one to five right for two and a half hours and how that settles out i mean this is you know what made it into the bill i'm not going to tell you i know all the numbers but if you have a low failure rate right in a school we may be comparable if you have a higher failure rate we clearly under the board's

[00:16:17] prescription would require more specialists than the 1 to 550 k3 does so i just think this language could be clarified and i'm sorry i don't have specific language but to be clear that the board's prescriptions in the soq have not yet been fully met by the vla changes specifically it doesn't the vla does not address grades four and five or were our where our were our changes all the way up or were they just through elementary what was our changes right now and as i recall them and i'm

[00:16:52] not going to tell you 100 but i believe it was elementary and the k-5 was really didn't say we had to you know deal with children k-5 what it said was you had a staff right based upon a number that number was calculated by the percent failing third grade times the enrollment in the school okay so but the ratio of uh you know reading specialist it was a one to five ratio with the kids right for two and a half hours of instruction so maybe the right way to ask it is to ask if the

[00:17:27] department can provide us some specifics by tomorrow then we can use that language but if not then we can maybe change our language here to just be clear that because the criteria were different it is the soq prescription need with uh withstands the changes made by the vla and so we want both in other words or we want whichever is higher or what do we want you see my question appreciate the progress but we think there's still work to be done yeah well especially

[00:18:05] in the the schools that are experiencing higher right so when i read this it was not clear to me whether what the m and we can say that maybe the way to say it is the the specialists added as part of the vla have helped reduce the need for additional uh specialists and may well bring down the budget impact but do not fully meet the needs of the um um soq prescription so some language like that and then maybe we should be asking kent to calculate what is the remaining

[00:18:43] budget impact so not in time for our paperwork paperwork but for the legislature what it is on the margin then instead of that's right because what we're asking for now is we'll be a little bit less cost i think it was 35 40 million originally for this piece and you know the what happened in the uh yeah that's fair uh the la was some portion of that yeah we had 37.9 million for this for the soq yeah for the soq so you're right i mean the increase would be less than this

[00:19:18] right so uh that's all i had on that one um i had one or two little technical things emily i can share with you separately my next one is as i say i appreciate you incorporating the jlark report one thing the jlark report did that i don't think this draft report does but i may have missed it it's the jlark report acknowledges that there was some modest rebound in sol scores in 2022

[00:19:55] and that in particular they cited that the schools and school divisions that had dropped the most had rebounded the most which was good news so sharing that little bit of good news i think is

important when we talk about student achievement we're talking pandemic learning loss but the this most recent school year modest rebound i think was the language that jlark used and uh so that would be my suggestion that we adopt that language there there is some of that on page 18 but did i miss certainly beat that up it says with the exception of writing students overall and students

[00:20:34] in all demographic groups made progress in the 21 22 compared to the performance during 2021 but happy to to beat that part up okay so maybe i missed that but i tell you i thought the modest rebound language and did you and what you just read did it say and that those who had dropped the most rebounded the most no that's i i don't have that in there but happy um um the next thing that there were a couple of other things that came from jlark jlark's characterization of we we just go back and talk about that point for a minute? I'm sorry. No, no, no. Yeah, I don't mind

[00:21:11] including factual data. I think that's fine. I think, you know, what the board thinks it means then is also important. And I would hate to have, you know, things in the report be misread to think that we believe that the system is currently, well, as it was resource-free pandemic, and even with a modest rebound post-pandemic, has got sufficient resources to take the COVID cohort through with the education that they ought to have at grade 12, by grade 12. You know, I think,

[00:21:47] and one of the things that wasn't addressed in the initial draft was, you know, we got sort of two issues, right? The system has stabilized, meaning that sort of the pre-pandemic system, we already believed was showing some cracks and achievement was sliding. And so we had done some things or we prescribed some things in 19, which we said, we're going to basically say to the stabilized system, You're not doing enough. It's going to take additional resources. Here's what we think.

[00:22:13] That includes both the teacher piece, the reading piece, you know, all those things that we talked about. Now we've got a second problem put on top of that first problem, right, which was much bigger, which is now you've got a cohort of kids coming through. And as somebody said this morning, I guess, Jenna, reading is cumulative.

[00:22:31] You know, how are we going to make up for the loss that occurred among those kids who were in the system when COVID hit and we shut down schools, which is a slightly different problem than how do you deal with the new kindergartner coming in for the first time into a stabilized in-person system. I hope this makes sense. But I sort of split the issues into two pieces now. One of them is a cohort moving through that has lost a year, year and a half, however you want to measure it, of educational attainment, right? And the other group of kids coming into a system that pre-pandemic in some places was doing very well,

[00:23:10] and other places were doing very poorly and we said in order to fix that very poorly here's what we have to do that's been compounded now by and you know we noted in 19 which is why that quote's there we've got a problem but then i guess using the house on fire analogy it was just the match was lit the house wasn't yet burning you know now post-pandemic we're seeing the house burning so uh i would like to see us maintain and this is just me not the board but you know speaking for me, sort of the understanding that we weren't doing enough before the pandemic, that's still

[00:23:46] got to be addressed. But the resources that it's going to take to bring us for the during pandemic cohort up to what ought to be expected are going to be over and above the stabilized system resources. And so if we're willing to put your comment in context, that is, you know, it's great that they had a rebound, but they didn't rebound to where we need them to be.

[00:24:11] absolutely and if you're a first grader who missed in-person reading you know during the pandemic and now you're moving into third grade next year and you're you are going to be behind right i mean it's just even if technically you can meet grade level you're going to be further behind than you were and i think we as a board at the commonwealth as a whole needs to address what that makeup is going to look like you know how are we going to fix that problem so i i hear you on all of that and I agree and happy to look at language that helps make I don't I don't think that being more

[00:24:47] specific about the data takes away from that that's right I just again if we're going to include the numbers I want to put a context around those numbers yeah so I'm happy to if you want to work on context language yeah tonight like yeah to torture your analogy Mr. President I feel like our role as the board is on these things always we're the fire inspector right our job's not to to talk up or down and i think like we should put all the data in there i think it's really important but we need to make sure we're not over indexing and we know like there's people who want to use this data just to run down the schools and we shouldn't be giving cover for that but likewise

[00:25:24] there's people who want to say okay sarah sarah this is we're doing they're rebounding and so like we're on a good track and this is all overhyped and that's a problem as well and so our job is to as best we can you know to mix metaphors call balls and strikes whatever be the fire inspector say what's going on um uh so i just want to make sure i i take your point so make sure we don't over index on we we don't want we should put in all the data an accurate picture but we don't give cover to to any particular narrative okay i've got two more um another one from jay

[00:26:02] larkin this is the first sentence under student achievement the current says results from the 2021-22 administration highlight both a long-term downward trend and the impact of the pandemic the long-term downward trend i would like to add after the word trend in some areas uh and i i i i would raise up the jlark characterization of what was happening before the pandemic was and i'm quoting prior to the pandemic most key indicators of virginia student academic achievement had been generally stable with the exception of elementary school reading scores which had been modestly

[00:26:40] declining for several years and i would say you know reading scores had been down and that's one of the impetuses of a virginia literacy act a huge huge important focus and i also think that if you look at some of the gaps there were some things that were going down in in for certain population groups but that the overall trends i think the uh uh j lark accurately reports that the longer-term trends were stable and therefore there should be some modifier in that long-term downward trend in some areas is the language i would propose can i propose a modification this

[00:27:17] is one where we may disagree because i think the words virginia's indicators are doing an awful lot of work in that sentence i mean i think we are establishing that we've got some problems with some of our indicators so i think like we need it's definitely it's not everything i totally take that point but we need to caveat there may be some problems with some of our indicators um you know particularly we're gonna have a conversation about cut scores um so i think we need to we see i'm not against that again i think we want to call balls and strikes but we just want to make sure we're like very clear virginia's indicators are in some some cases fairly uh falsified if you will by

[00:27:54] other data that we see and not just the nape that's the act we see like so i think we want to we just want to be very careful how we phrase that i'll just check out what page we're on oh okay i'm on page 17. we're talking about i have it at the bottom of page 16 but it's because i'm looking at the wrong track so

it's under student achievement and the language i would be proposing to add is in the very first sentence after the word downward trend in some areas could we be very specific about yeah i mean because yeah i would be okay with that highlight a long-term

[00:28:31] downward trend in reading and the impact of the pandemic more broadly but i'm not sure that would meet mr rotherham's needs i think we need something in here somewhere that gets at do we do we have confidence in all of these indicators i mean we have that enormous delta that we see between nape and sol do we do we have full confidence like essentially jlark is is and as as is appropriate what they're doing there is they're saying based on virginia indicators our role is slightly different do we have confidence that those are the right barometers at this point and i would suggest the best way to address that is to say somewhere that we're we're hoping to look at and

[00:29:10] learn more about those you know what are the implications of those differences i'd be fine with that would you also be comfortable if we put something like and there's discrepancies between those indicators and some again some other yeah it's not all because i think they're measuring different things so just the word discrepancy would give me i would not be comfortable what's a word that and others should obviously weigh in here writing by committee is a lot of fun but others should jump jump in what's the way what's the way to i just want to make sure we don't like i mean part of the problem i think here is we have some indicators that we have questions about

[00:29:48] their utility and and then a whole bunch of questions about how do we actually make them better but we don't have answers to that yet so i don't want to get ahead of ourselves but i think we have to indicate that in this particular language that i'm raising up and i hear you you may have something somewhere else but we're talking about trends and they're the trend line in these the sol results nothing's changed significantly in the uh measurement tools on any of that in the trend range that we're talking about the last the english language for instance that that reading drop that i asked um uh jenna about i think we did uh when we had a new test

[00:30:27] come out we recalibrate we had a change in the numbers on english language in 2012 that's why we went from 85 percent pass right down to 70 but there's been no change in that since there's been no change in the uh cut scores or anything else that would impact any of the rest of that since then so it sounds yeah it sounds like what we needed some more precise trend data over time downward trend or stable trend in the sol scores i don't think there's been any monkeying with the numbers that's affected that we still haven't got we asked and dr ballad maybe you can help we've

[00:31:03] asked for uh sort of audit on or not an audit stuff i have the right word but an accounting of all the cut score changes we can make sure everyone's on the same page is that coming i see you reaching are you reaching for it my heart is a flood or were you no i wish i wish i was i wish i was reaching for it that is part of the presentation tomorrow there's going to be a discussion tomorrow about considerations in the process around cut scores i don't know that an audit is in place well an audit's not the right word just like a baseline so we all like are operating from the state because like i don't right i might when you ask me that my answer is

[00:31:40] i don't know because i don't know all the changes and so like we need to get we need so so i i would suggest that the solution here is maybe to add back in some language that we're going to be exploring cut scores and exploring the implications studying something like that i think in the the looking ahead section potentially adding some language you know like being said about exploring um differences

between what so wells measure and what date measures and considerations moving forward may be a better place to put that yeah i'm not

[00:32:19] suggesting i think of some full-throated attack on the sol but i'm also not suggesting we say that That's a measure that everyone here's here's some language maybe in that looking forward exploring the implications of the differences between different measures see NAEP SOL does that meet your yeah I would get probably brought it but between NAEP and other national measures because we see this like a CT is yeah No, and I'm exploring the implications of the differences Yeah, and I think there's potentially other data that districts are using that sort of tell that story

[00:32:51] I'm a little confused. I've never heard anybody suggest that the SOLs don't measure what we say they measure. And we've been using them in Virginia for a long time. I'm not aware we've had problems getting our kids into colleges and moving on with life. I understand that there may be a desire to put a separate measure in place that looks like higher expectations. That I get, but I don't, I'm just, number one, in the seven years I've been on the board, we have never changed a cut score. I mean, they don't change them. They get set once when a new test is done,

[00:33:29] right? Cut scores go once per test. And so, you know, that hasn't happened. You know, Dr. Sieber, you were a superintendent for a long time. Do you have any reason to believe that the SOLs don't measure what we think they measure? I think it comes back to the idea. We're required to go my statute anyway at this point we have we have a system but i think mr alkan's point was that we use multiple measures and and again how we try to align them or not align them is a challenge because the different measures have different purposes right and if we make them all the same we don't need multiple measures anymore so so i think the the idea that we we do have multiple measures

[00:34:05] different purposes and whereas i what i'm hearing is there's scrutiny about you know what the what the scores mean for the state probably not so much for individual as much individual i think that there's yes there's scrutiny about that but there's also a baseline scrutiny about the assessments themselves which are still largely a 1990s architecture and and that you know there's there's bigger pieces here at play that i so again how we wordsmith this i'm not sure but i i think that um i i started to hear a little origin toward the move toward um being more discreet about

[00:34:41] these are the things we see in specific data points but that again i don't even want to hitch You know, Mr. Rodgham was saying there's other national indicators out there. I don't even want to hitch all our wagons to NAEP. I think we need, again, multiple indicators are the tools that we need to use to look at things.

[00:34:58] Not arguing the second point, I guess it's the first, which is, you know, the explanation this board has had about SOLs is they indicate minimal proficiency, right, in order to move on. And that's what they measure, period. I have never heard anybody question that they're not a good measure of minimal proficiency.

[00:35:19] Now, you have the fundamental question, should we be content with minimal proficiency or should we require more, right? You have all that can be talked about. But I guess I'm concerned that the idea that the SOLs, which we've given here, what, for 20-something years, 25 years, this is the first I've heard, honestly, Andy, anybody say they don't measure what we say they measure.

[00:35:43] Well, that's not, I mean, that's not quite right. We have, I mean, we have, like, we're talking about the discrepancy between NAEP, and people can say the NAEP standard's too high. Well, no, they also say they measure something different than the SOLs. What I'm saying, your comment, I think, was that we're calling the question. Yeah, and I don't want, I do not, I want to be clear, I'm not arguing that we use this report in any way to launch some sort of assault on the SOLs or anything else.

[00:36:07] I just think we want to make sure that we are telling that sort of our current levels of pass rates on the SOLs, a reasonable observer could say that that is insufficient. The standard is too low. There's evidence there. i just want to make sure we you know again we don't need to you know we don't need to jump into some big right here but then we are we are accurately especially given the context of the conversations we're going to have just literally later this afternoon that we are just accurately that this is stuff we are looking at to figure out so just in the context of the report though you just said i think i certainly don't want to call into question the bona fides

[00:36:45] of the sols and what they measure i think that's fine but we need to point out there's other indicators that i think we can get i think we can get involved throughout this report right all right i just want to make sure yeah pages of name it's not like we're ignoring it right there's nape there's act i just want to make sure we are very clear every time we say like things you know that we where things are going up like there's been a rebound in some of the hardest hit divisions we should say that this is not about like telling one kind of a story or another but that we are providing appropriate context i think is really important especially given the conversations

[00:37:21] we're going to be having so that they can be grounded in in what we know and what we don't know so just to bring it back to some language maybe something in a looking forward section about studying the implications of uh the or exploring how the sol results implications compare to the implications of other assessments yeah and how our standards something about how are you know our our standards and what we're asking of schools and students are they sufficient and all that again i don't think we need to provide answers but questions we're going to be looking at maybe how we can use multiple measures to better understand where students are i would say rather than use

[00:38:01] but consider because yeah we don't yeah yeah right consider yeah i'm trying yeah i'm trying to make sure we're not like prejudging right i could live with that kind of language in the looking forward um uh and then my should i move on to my last one um uh chronic absenteeism is highlighted in the jlark report in a major way as a very significant continuing problem from the pandemic and i don't think that we i mean it was mentioned if at all maybe i meant missed it

[00:38:35] but i think it was not mentioned in any significant way in our report and i think it should be um and and one of the things jlark raised up was that apparently the department uh well we have some we the board have some obligation to look at how we deal with chronic absenteeism in terms of accountability and accreditation but the the department is supposed to be spending money

[00:39:07] on a tenant support program and jlark suggests that we're got a procurement out or something and you know maybe maybe we could update jlark a little because jlark made it sound like we're That it's a work in progress, but maybe that there's a need to accelerate that work was the what I read between the lines on JLARC And so if we are if there is something the departments Got that shows progress on the department providing this tool that will help divisions Address chronic absenteeism that might be worth highlighting

[00:39:42] But maybe that's too much into the department not the board and so I defer to you mr. Gecker But the certainly the measures of chronic absenteeism our appropriate report on the the state of the land no objection including something on No, in fact, I would know I agree with that I had like Jayler also hired a highlighted student behavior And we and we're there's not a lot in there in our report on that either I thought I think you're right and they did a nice job saying the data limitations

[00:40:18] But this is ties the teacher piece teachers you hear this anecdotally and it shows up like and we're talking about all these reasons teachers are leaving, but one of them is they're really struggling with behavior. And I think we should, I think just in terms of, you know, JLARC, I think did a nice job of surfacing that in their analysis. And we should, you know, to the extent we can borrow from them without getting hit for plagiarism, it seems like we probably should. Yeah. Mr. President, on that note, that was one thing that I did feel very strongly about in being included in this report is the discipline piece

[00:40:53] that was brought up by JLARC because there was no correlation to any changes in policy that have happened either within the department or from the General Assembly. And I think that that's important to think about too because it is strongly correlated to teacher retention, but it is also strongly correlated to strong principal leadership in school buildings. And so I think that's kind of a cross-pollination of where we need to,

[00:41:30] you know, additionally goes to student achievement. And so I think that addressing discipline and how, I mean, obviously, you know, Jay Lark came to their report and said, look, I mean, after kids have been home for the time that they had been home, they aren't used to the confines and rules technically of the school building and what is expected of them and i think probably when schools reopened you know the adults in the building were like okay we're going back to to the way it was well i mean you haven't given

[00:42:09] so many of those kids who maybe that's a short-term memory type type um process for them they they have to be really just completely reoriented to what's expected of them daily as much as you know teachers and school administrators have to have that reorientation as well you know and the children who were new to school you know so they came into what going into second grade and they had never had in classroom expectations before in a lot of

[00:42:45] a lot of uh our school divisions so um i think the discipline issue absolutely has to be addressed here we have some of the j-lark stuff in your spare time doing that with them all right uh anybody else have comments or are we relatively okay with the direction at least of the report

[00:43:23] where are we landing mr president on requests the version the last version i read still had 2021 requests which it sounds like a lot we we've done reasonably like where are we i mean the only one is confused where are we where are we landing on like specific asks i don't think we have any real specific ask we have a restatement of the prescribed soqs which okay that's my question we're comfortable with that do we want to other things we want to add well that was my question that was my question yeah and i don't mind discussing what we want to add but let me just

[00:43:59] to say again, as we started this with, the board hasn't really had an in-depth look at what it is we want, where things are going. And so I'm a little hesitant to sort of make ask before we've done the work to know what it is we want to ask for. I think the resource piece, I haven't heard anybody say, no, that's not right. The cohort rolling through the pandemic piece, I haven't heard anybody say, no, that's not right. Those are pretty clear from the data. We highlight the

[00:44:32] We talk about the discrepancies, and, you know, unless there's a movement to take out the old prescriptions, which I hope there's not. And I want to be clear, I don't have a list up my sleeve that I'm about to unveil.

[00:44:48] I just think we should talk about it and think about is there anything we want? That's all I was asking. Dr. Siebert. So, Claire, my understanding was that the board went through a process for its 2021 standard quality prescriptions, but I think what you're opening the door for, Mr. Rotherham, is that maybe not on that numbered list, but in that section, what else would you be asking for?

[00:45:19] I think that's what he's saying. Gotcha, okay. I will say nothing made it on the list previously, which is not to say we can't do it this time, that hadn't taken a year and a half of board work to get there. Right. I mean, I will say that. And, you know, it's, again, people can disagree with the conclusions, but I don't think anybody would disagree that the board spent a lot of thoughtful effort coming to those conclusions.

[00:45:43] And so I hesitate. Again, it has been sort of my desire to have this board thought upon and actually be a body that debates policy in a thoughtful way based upon data, you know, research, et cetera. And, I mean, if there's some obvious asks we want to do, let's talk about them.

[00:46:00] But other than that, like I said, I personally, this is personal, not as chair, prefer that that the work reflect the actual work product of the board as opposed to being a wish list. - I agree. And I don't think anything's baked enough, but I feel like it's important to talk about it 'cause when we get asked this, particularly who knows what'll happen in the assembly session and so forth, there's two answers.

[00:46:23] One's we didn't talk about that. And one is we talked about that, but we didn't have the analysis done on things to move forward. And I think I prefer personally, I prefer one of those answers to the other. I think it just behooves us just to pause on it for a beat.

[00:46:39] But I mean, but that's been the philosophy of the report in the past, at least, again, five years of them. So what I'm hearing, so what comes to my mind, Mr. President, is I think that if we do move in this direction of separating accountability and accreditation and looking at assessment and accountability in big tech, I think there's going to be resource needs there that the states were going to, but I don't know how we articulate that at this point.

[00:47:01] But I absolutely feel, yeah, there's some big things on the horizon. I just don't know how we articulate for this report. And remember, what this report really is, in terms of our mandate, is a report on the actual condition and needs. It's not the wish list report. We have used it to set the stage for various things, and we've used the data to explain why we think those things need to occur, but no buts there.

[00:47:28] It's just, you know, that's what we've known in the past. It does not mean that that is what we need to do as a board in the future. I'm explaining context, I guess. are we good in terms of direction and uh so dr mann you're going to come up with a nuanced paragraph through the fingers i got that phrase i'm going to start using that phrase i like that one okay and emily you're gonna you got a couple things to steal from plagiarizing jaylock yeah that's right professionally appropriate and i guess as soon as you cite it it's no longer

[00:48:07] plagiarism so uh but in terms of the tone i mean like i said we indicate we have learning needs i I hope we indicate we're gonna need resources in two different camps, two different levels.

[00:48:27] All right, thank you all for taking a look at this. And again, I apologize to all of you for not having it done much more promptly during the month.

[00:48:42] Okay, it's Hyslop, good afternoon. I've been told that the appropriate person to introduce you is Mr. Rotherham. And although this is a tremendous breach of protocol, we're gonna let him do it.

[00:48:59] will try to be both brief and take advantage of the opportunity. It's actually easy to be accurate at Anne. Anne is fantastic. I'm super glad you decided to come over today. She actually lives in Richmond. She's gradually been married, so lots of good Virginia pedigree. I know her a couple different ways. We worked together at a think tank. She was with us at Bellwether when we were uh smaller and scrappier uh and after leaving us she went to the department and uh led efforts on accountability at the federal level for the obama department of education she's now at the alliance

[00:49:35] for excellent education where she is uh director of policy development she can i'll leave it to her to tell you more of it it's a uh sort of education i don't know how like policy advocacy organization um uh that the former congressman bob wise led for a long time uh and just terrific super thoughtful on these issues, deeply committed to addressing disparities in outcomes. And just really, as I said, I'll say it a second time, just one of the most incredibly thoughtful people about this who sort of balances that deep commitment with a real attention to the craft of policy and getting it right. We are delighted to have you. And if you've impressed, Andy, that's more

[00:50:15] than enough for me, I'll tell you. Thank you. I look forward to what you have to say. Yeah, no, thank you so much for having me today um it's really an honor to present to y'all especially virginia near and dear to my heart and this topic is also very dear and dear to my heart um so a little bit about me you know i have spent probably the last 10 years really researching and analyzing school accountability systems back under no child left behind but then in particular at the u.s department of education right when the every student succeeds act was being passed and then implemented work with a number of states including wyoming when i was at chiefs for change on sort

[00:50:53] of developing essay implementation plans and now i'm at um officially now like bellwether we are just all for ed um so we used to be the alliance for excellent education but we rebranded ourselves to all for ed about a year ago we really though are an organization um small non-profit that's historically been focused on that transition from high school to higher education so ensuring that students graduate not just sort of with the bare minimum but also really prepared for whatever is next in their journey college or career so that's historically what we have done but we also I think recognize them in order for

[00:51:30] students to be ready for college and career you need to pay attention to a lot of other aspects of the k-12 system so we also focus not just around college and career pathways but on assessments and accountability issues on closing the digital divide and issues around resource equity. And I lead our policy team have been there for about four years, but have worked in and around DC for about a decade, even though I'm now officially in Virginia. So I think the thing that I really wanted to ground today's discussion with, I'm so excited that Virginia is considering rethinking its accountability system. I think

[00:52:09] now is a really ripe time for that because, in particular at the federal level, accountability systems were paused because of COVID. You know, we just said, this is not the right time to be worrying about identifying schools or assessing students. We don't have the data we need. So all of these systems are now just coming back online after a couple years off.

[00:52:29] And so it's a really prime time and an opportunity to take a breath and see are our systems actually working for us. There are definitely lots of different goals of accountability systems. These are the three that I identify as being some of the most important. The first, and I think I've even heard this in a lot of your comments today, around the discussion that you were just having, is public transparency about school quality, being really clear to families, to educators, to teach other teachers and the system and school leaders, and to just the public in general, not to mention sort of general assembly members and actual policymakers.

[00:53:06] It's also an opportunity, though, to really identify and incentivize state priorities for students learning and success. You know, you often hear like we measure what matters. And by choosing to put a particular data point or indicator in your accountability system, it's really a signal that this is something that our school systems and educators should be working on and prioritizing potentially over other components of the education system.

[00:53:34] And I think this is actually one of the biggest shifts that I've seen in accountability in the last 10 years, is that it's about informing school improvement and resource allocation. I think under No Child Left Behind, in particular, it was seen kind of as a way to blame and punish schools for the data and results they had.

[00:53:54] And I think we've shifted that mindset more now to this is a way of identifying schools that need additional help. And can we provide them extra resources, extra funding, extra technical assistance from the Virginia Department of Ed or from, you know, other sort of state technical assistance opportunities. It's not about shaming and blaming. It's really about figuring out which schools and divisions need extra supports and helping them engage in the improvement process. So I think that that's been a really important shift and something that I keep in mind when I think about what makes an effective accountability system. So these are just some key components of an

[00:54:31] accountability system. These are just the ones I'm focusing on today. I probably could have spent the whole day kicking out on accountability with y'all. But these are some of the ones that I thought were most important for you all to sort of start thinking about as you explore this potential journey of rethinking accreditation and accountability and how that works in the Commonwealth. So the first piece here is thinking about the system for differentiating between schools. In particular, I think there's an interest that I've heard from Emily and others around

[00:55:06] how can we have a system that meets both the federal requirements in the Every Student Succeeds Act, but also sort of our state priorities. So I think considering those federal requirements, but also sort of what are the state-selected measures that are really important. So what indicators can we use? How should we calculate and report those indicators? And then should we have an overall school rating? When ESSA was being passed, this was one of the hot topics of conversation about should we be providing these sort of overall A through F school grades or one to five stars or is a dashboard approach better? So these are all questions I think for y'all to ponder moving

[00:55:43] forward. I think another key question though is how individual student groups are considered. This is something that we've spent a lot of time at All4Ed exploring as we do work on ESSA implementation. So can a school earn a high rating overall if it has a struggling group of students, students disabilities english learners students from low-income families um which indicators are disaggregated by student groups for accountability purposes when it comes to school report cards everything is

disaggregated for the most part with accountability systems you can sort of pick and choose maybe this is a measure that we're only going to look at for all students and this is a

[00:56:20] measure that we'd like to disaggregate and then finally um how many students have to be enrolled in a particular group to count also known as the n size and so within a given school if a group is small enough that it feels like the data won't be valid or reliable that group might be excluded so these are some of the components i'm going to talk about today there are other ones that are not on this list because i didn't want to keep you all here until eight o'clock um i thought this would be a good way to start so i'm going to have sort of a section on indicators a section on ratings and a section on inclusion of individual groups of students i'm happy to pause sort of

[00:56:58] after each of those sections for questions and discussion then if there is any because i know sometimes it's good to answer questions in the moment as opposed to waiting until the end um but if there are no questions i'll just move on so focusing on the indicators first to start i think i wanted to ground this conversation a little bit and just what's required federally before talking about sort of particular choices states have made especially since there is this desire to have one system not two accountability systems some states do have two accountability systems a separate federal system and a separate state system um i typically recommend not going

[00:57:36] down that route if you can avoid it because it's very confusing to the public when you have two different ratings operating at once so the first indicator that's required federally is just an academic achievement indicator um focused on the math and english language arts assessments um that's typically you know your proficiency rate how many students are meeting grade level standards in those two subject areas and i will note that you have to sort of take into account assessment participation rates so 95 of students at least in that school have to be in the denominator for the measure the second indicator is one that depends on the grade span of the

[00:58:15] school. So for your K-8 schools, those that don't have a graduating cohort, it's just called the other academic indicator. Typically, that is often academic growth in math and English language arts as opposed to like a proficiency rate. But some states use science proficiency or other measures.

[00:58:32] So that is one of those indicators where there is a great deal of state choice. For high schools, there is less choice. It needs to be the four-year adjusted cohort graduation rate. States can add a five-year or six-year rate, but it has to include the four-year rate, and I will just note that that rate does not include students who earn a GED or other high school sort of completion certificate.

[00:58:54] It is only students who earn the standard diploma or the advanced studies diploma in Virginia. The third required indicator is a measure that just applies to schools with English learners in sufficient numbers, and that's the progress toward English language proficiency based on the ELP assessment. And then finally, the fourth indicator is school quality or student success.

[00:59:17] And this is the one where I think there's probably the most variety, the most room for state innovation and state choice. The federal law just says that these indicators need to be valid, reliable, statewide, comparable, and meaningfully differentiate schools. The other thing that I will note is that the indicators that have asterisks, federal law says that these indicators should have more weight in the system than those school quality for student success indicators so that's what the federal law looks like and i wanted before sort of diving into how virginia looks

[00:59:53] against indicators and sort of what other states are doing and some examples of interesting things around indicators is these are four questions that i always ask when i'm thinking about and giving advice to state policy makers about what indicators are worth considering for accountability systems some of these are rooted in those federal requirements but others are just things that are going to make the system work better. The first is that asking, is this measure valid, reliable, comparable, and measured in the same way? This of course is rooted in those federal requirements. By validity, I just mean, is this data point actually measuring the thing we think it should be measuring? So if we're trying to measure college and career readiness, is the ACT

[01:00:33] and SAT score a good measure of that? Or is there something that's going to be more valid? Reliable just means that the measure can be, it's going to be consistent and measured in the same way over time from year to year. Being comparable and measured in the same way, that's probably something that's in the state longitudinal data system. So there's a consistency across the way that districts are calculating that data and reporting it to the state. So I think that's pretty straightforward. The second piece here is also something rooted in federal law, and that is, can the measure be disaggregated? I said that, you know, you don't necessarily have to look at every single student group on every single indicator, but it needs to be able to be reported

[01:01:12] that way. And that means you're thinking about student-level data. An indicator like teacher retention cannot be disaggregated by Black students, white students, low-income students. It would be very hard to do that. So it's not the teacher retention isn't an interesting measure.

[01:01:28] It just might not be suited for a school accountability system that would meet federal requirements. The third question, I think, is this, does the measure allow for meaningful differentiation and that is it could be a really interesting measure but if every school basically gets the same results on that measure it's not going to do much to help you know which schools are doing well and which ones may need that additional support and then finally is progress on this measure related to improvements in student learning if the whole point of this is to figure out which schools are doing a good job of supporting students and meeting greater level expectations and graduating college and career ready is doing better on that measure going to

[01:02:07] help meet that goal. So apologize for the very teeny tiny font. There is a link here to the actual source, but I wanted to start just with a little bit of a landscape of what states have chosen, especially for the indicators where there is choice, you know, that school quality student success indicator. And far and away, the most common indicator states have chosen, and Virginia is also one of those, is chronic absenteeism. It is the top measure that was chosen. Most of the other measures that states really were interested in exploring, and I should note this data comes

[01:02:43] from 2018, so the numbers may have shifted slightly since then, but all of those darker blue bars are college and career readiness measures. Typically AP, IB, SAT results or ACT scores, students doing dual enrollment or earning college credit, but there are also a number of career measures, so things like completing an industry certification or work-based learning pathway. The ACT work case assessment is on there. So there's been a sort of a plethora and a proliferation of college and career-ready measures. The career-ready ones, I wanted to point out, were those with the purple arrows that I put next to them. I think there has been sort of

[01:03:23] slightly less innovation around some of the other measures that are not high school specific. But like I said, chronic absenteeism is very popular. You also see a few states, though, that are looking at school climate or student engagement survey results. You see access to the fine arts or physical education has been included. Suspension rates and student discipline has been included in some states. And early literacy and reading is another popular, somewhat popular measure across states. So that's sort of the national landscape. Here in Virginia, I thought it would be helpful, this is just my analysis, of overlaying the indicators that are currently used

[01:04:02] Virginia accreditation against those federal indicators. This is for K-8 schools. So as you can see, the combined rate for a Virginia accreditation is actually meeting or including components of three federal indicators. It's including academic achievement. It's also including other academic indicator, the other academic indicator by considering student growth or progress in English language arts and math. And then it's also considering English language proficiency. Virginia is the only state I know of that uses a combined rate in this way and reports

[01:04:40] a combined rate this way. Every other indicator that is in Virginia accreditations for K-8 schools would be considered a school quality or student success indicator. That's science, the achievement gaps among student groups, and then chronic absenteeism. The other sort of looking at this for high school kind of a similar story plays out where Virginia is actually using what probably would be considered many more school quality student success indicators than the bare minimum so that um science english achievement and math achievement gaps the dropout rate chronic

[01:05:17] absenteeism and the college and career ready college career and civic readiness index which i know hasn't been fully implemented yet would all be considered school quality indicators um the overall proficiency is not um it's still sort of doing double duty by including english language proficiency as well and then there is this kind of the graduation completion piece as well more or less the standalone graduation rate indicator i will just note again that the completion metrics in the graduation and completion um accreditation indicator would not be considered part of the graduation rate indicator because that's going beyond just

[01:05:54] that cohort graduation rate so consider ged completion um ged completion can be included as a school quality indicator it's just that the u.s department of education wouldn't consider that to meet the graduation rate indicator for federal purposes. So I think running through all that, I wanted to just sort of give you my take. Again, this is my take. Happy to hear disagreement on this about some considerations for you all. If you're thinking about how could we improve these indicators that we're using in our accreditation standards? And this is going back again to those four questions that I raised earlier of, you know, is the measure valid,

[01:06:30] reliable, comparable from states across the state? Can it be disaggregated? Is it meaningfully differentiating schools, and is it something that is actually linked to student learning? So, my first primary recommendation would be to consider separating the combined rate into three standalone indicators.

[01:06:52] And this goes back to that question of validity. What is a combined rate measuring? It's actually measuring three different things. It's measuring students' academic achievement, and students' academic progress, and English language proficiency.

[01:07:07] are three separate concepts. And it's a lot, I think a lot easier for the public to see or for anyone to sort of understand that, well, here's how a school is doing on achievement. And here's how a school is

doing when it comes to growth and progress. You might see some schools that are hitting it out of the park when it comes to helping students grow and make gains from year to year, even though their students are not yet meeting grade level proficiency standards. But you don't see that with a combined rate because it's all combined into one measure. I'd also say that that, you know, it's wonderful when English learners are making progress toward proficiency,

[01:07:44] but I also want to know if English learners are doing well in reading and math and academic content, not just doing well in, you know, attaining English language proficiency. I would also just add here, too, that the way Virginia is measuring growth is perhaps not as nuanced or sophisticated as most other states. Virginia's combined rate only considers student growth for students who not proficient. So if students are not meeting grade level of standards in the FOLs, they could then be counted in the combined rate if they've moved sort of half a performance level. So maybe they've gone from a low below basic to a high below basic. Other states measure student growth

[01:08:23] typically using something called a student growth percentile, which basically looks at students who had similar academic achievement in the last year and says, well, did that student grow relatively more or relatively less than other similar students this year. So if a student, you know, had a student growth percentile in the 70th percentile, that means that compared to similar students, that student sort of was in the top quarter for growth. And that's a measure that can be calculated for students who were already proficient and advanced to make sure they continue on that trajectory, as well as for students who are far below proficiency. So it gives you more

[01:09:01] data, more nuanced data about growth than the current way that Virginia is looking at growth, is only really looking at students who are not yet proficient and really requiring you to sort of see did you get at least half a performance level a student growth percentile could tell you if they grew you know not even that whole half a performance level but part way so we just give more and richer information about student progress the second sort of overarching theme i think that would be good for the board to consider would be streamlining some of the high school indicators to focus on measures with the most value um i would consider removing or de-emphasizing dropout

[01:09:40] rates one of the reasons is that dropout is um a measure that doesn't actually show a great deal of variation between schools relative to other measures so that question about does this do a good job of differentiating schools dropout rates doesn't do as good a job as chronic absenteeism or college and career readiness or graduation rates i would also consider potentially taking out the high school completion metric entirely just because again that fourth question does progress on this measure actually lead to better student outcomes and what we see looking at the data is that having a ged is not a good foundation for a student to succeed beyond high school and

[01:10:18] i'm not sure that's something that the board would want to be emphasizing as much as getting that standard diploma or that advanced study diploma i will say that essa does include some flexibility around considering students with significant cognitive disabilities and how they can be calculated or considered as a graduate in that standard adjusted cohort graduation rate which Virginia could explore doing where they you know you could sort of have a modified diploma but just for students that have the most significant cognitive disabilities so that's just something I would

[01:10:54] consider it it's true yeah this is really helpful so this is just i'll save most questions for later but just to clarify on that one if we were to remove the completion rate i.e just go with the federal definition of

graduation we could are you suggesting we do that as an indicator in accountability but that would not necessarily mean we change our definition of graduation for whether a kid gets a diploma. Correct. Walks across the stage. Yes, you could do that. It would

[01:11:28] just mean that the graduation rate that's reported for accountability would only include students that have the standard diploma or the advanced diploma. And if Virginia was interested in going down this route of sort of submitting a modified diploma that was only for students who take the alternate assessment, who are the most significant cognitive disabilities, that is something the Department of Education could submit to the U.S. Department of Education, which would then allow that federal cohort rate to include students who got the standard diploma, students who got the

[01:12:04] advanced diploma, as well as those students with significant cognitive disabilities who graduated sort of with that alternate diploma. So those I think are some considerations. The other thing I do mention here is de-emphasizing. One of the things that can be considered is you all are thinking about changes to your accountabilities is how do we weight different indicators instead of one option is just remove an indicator remove a measure entirely but it can also another option is to say well we're going to give that twice as less weight as this other measure that we think is

[01:12:39] really important so this is going to be worth five points but this will be worth 20 points so there is that's kind of an in-between route if there's a desire to keep a measure in without removing it entirely i would also um want to offer just a few recommendations around the college career civic Readiness Index in particular. We at All4Ed have a report coming out in January that is really diving into and does a landscape of how all 50 states are measuring college career and civic readiness. And so I wanted to sort of preview some of our findings from that. The first would be considering an index to actually incentivize college career pathways with the greatest value

[01:13:18] beyond high school. Most states, when they put college career civic readiness into their accountability systems, they treat every single pathway the same. So taking a dual enrollment course is the same as completing an industry-recognized credential, is the same as getting a certain score on the ACT, is the same as, you know, enrolling in college without remediation.

[01:13:42] They're all the same. But some states, and this is an example from Louisiana, go beyond that to actually say, well, we're going to give points to different opportunities or put more weight on certain opportunities over others. In Louisiana's case, the pathway with the most points is students who actually earn an associate's degree in high school, but you also get 150 extra points if you have the standard high school diploma plus earning college credit through AP or doing what's called an advanced jumpstart credential, which is the CTE credentials in Louisiana. So that's like completing

[01:14:20] a college career pathway with a credential so they're kind of saying we have all these potential measures but we're kind of putting our thumb on the scale to really encourage schools to support students through these pathways so i think that that's sort of taking the college career readiness measures one step further to say these are the ones we truly value and we truly want to help help students achieve okay just maybe going back and I'm on the dropout issue just are there ways to still quantify though the nonlinear for the you know

[01:14:55] the pathways and the on-ramps and the off-ramps that some students take to be able to have them counted or articulated in some of these other college or job ready issues yeah and I mean I think this is a great example here I'm glad you picked up on that in Louisiana, where they actually do include

students who have GEDs, the HICET, in this Strength of Diploma Index, but they're giving it less weight than the 100.

[01:15:24] So if the 100 is you graduated with our standard diploma in Louisiana, you can get partial credit for high school completers. So that's a way of sort of keeping that in there and recognizing it that it is a pathway but perhaps saying we're encouraging schools to try and get as many students to not be completing that pathway and to maybe go for one that has more points um and i think they even show too with some of this um you know if you have that completion uh sort of completion

[01:15:56] but also a credential that's worth more points than just doing the ged so if you get that ged but you also have an industry recognized jumpstart credential that the state sort of vets they're they're getting more points. So I think it's a sophisticated way of trying to recognize all the different post-secondary options and post-secondary pathways, but say, here are some that we think are leading to the best possible outcomes for students. And they do a good job, too, I think, of balancing college-oriented versus career-oriented measures. The next piece, and this font is super tiny,

[01:16:35] this example comes from Georgia. And I think one thing that is worth doing, so speaking of college-oriented versus career-oriented is that I think it's really helpful when states present an overall college and career readiness rate, but also report each readiness option separately.

[01:16:52] So you can see, well, how many students actually, you know, met the readiness through AP or IB versus how many students met the readiness credential by work-based learning or through some other sort of career pathway. It just gives you more nuanced data, and this is especially important if you then start to see disparities.

[01:17:10] And what we see that our Black and Latinx students are overwhelmingly showing readiness through certain pathways, but our white students are not. You know, it could show some racial disparities. It could show economic disparities, disparities between divisions in Virginia that are really interesting.

[01:17:26] You just don't get that information if you only present that top line number. It's also, I think, really interesting. And one thing I wanted to call out for Georgia, they're one of four states that actually uses post-secondary outcomes that are beyond high school. in their case they were looking at schools students who enroll in public colleges in georgia without needing remediation as one of their college and career readiness measures so i think that's just again pushing it further to say you know we hope that students who do well in the sat or who earn ap credit do well in college but they're actually using some of their

[01:18:01] data that shows and in fact they did do well in college because um we're looking at that you know being able to enter college level coursework are they doing it through the clearinghouse are they doing it through their own student identifier so in their case they're doing it through their own student identifier because they're looking at remediation rates um and the clearinghouse usually is not providing remediation rate data but there are like in i think michigan's case and connecticut i think they're just looking at enrollment and they're using clearinghouse data which typically includes you know all institutions nationwide as opposed to just

[01:18:35] in state public schools all right that's the end of indicators um so i'm happy to take other questions about um you know before moving on to sort of discussion about ratings but if there are other things that have come up that would be helpful to clarify now um how do you so hearing good i'll just

breeze on through to that accountability rating so this is these are those questions about should we have an overall school rating or score um and if so how should we could think about weighting these indicators or combining them to produce it so first of all i just want to

[01:19:14] say ESSA does not require states to issue overall school ratings, like A3F grades, one to five stars, an index score out of, you know, a certain number of points. This is something that is entirely up to states. What ESSA does require is that states need to report school performance on every indicator, disaggregated at the school, district, and state level, and that it also requires states to identify three categories of low-performing schools so even if there's not an overall school grade or you get three out of five stars um states are needing to distinguish here the schools will

[01:19:53] need extra support so that's sort of like a rating but it's not quite the same thing and then i think one thing that i sort of mentioned before again is that if a state does choose to use a school rating um like a one to five star system it does need to emphasize those required federal indicators achievement graduation rate progress in english language proficiency um more than the school quality indicators what much greater and substantial means is not defined so i'm happy to like give guidance on um what states have been able to

[01:20:31] get approved but for the most part um i think it's a pretty loose definition so just keep those things in mind. I mentioned that there are three categories of schools under ESSA, so this is for states that don't have an overall rating. They are at least distinguishing schools in these three categories. Two of the categories, targeted support and additional targeted support, are really focused on schools that have low performing groups of students. So students with disabilities who are struggling, Hispanic students who are struggling, not necessarily whole school performance. That third category comprehensive support and improvement is the lowest performing five percent of title one

[01:21:10] schools and that is focused on sort of schools that are having um overall challenges um across the indicators it also includes any high school with graduation rates below 67 percent um so i think that that's just sort of keeping in mind those categories the other sort of interesting thing is um that third category for the most part is limited to title one schools but the other two categories are not limited to title one schools in any school that has a struggling subgroup and defined by the state however you would like to define consistently under forming and then you also have differences in how frequently the schools are identified so

[01:21:50] category two and three can be identified once every three years which is what virginia has chosen to do while category one is identified annually this identification is what was paused during the pandemic so schools have were sort of identified for support in that 2019-2020 school year and then the U.S. Department of Education said you do not need to identify any new schools in the 2020-21 school year or the 21-22 school year however schools were identified this year

[01:22:23] so those ratings or identification I should say ratings have now resumed this academic year so before even like diving in i think it's just i mentioned this school ratings were very controversial when every student succeeds act was being debated and so i think it's just worth saying like here are the arguments that typically are made for why you should have a rating versus why you should maybe go with something that's more like a data dashboard so those that generally prefer school writing say we think they're transparent clear user-friendly you know parents may not understand

[01:23:01] all the ins and outs of a college and career readiness index but one to five stars is very intuitive to understand and it gives you sort of a high level snapshot it also gives that ability sort of emphasize certain indicators over others because you are putting all the indicators together and giving them different weights saying you know we're going to have college and career readiness worth 50 of the high school rating the graduation rate worth 30 because we really want to emphasize college and career readiness i think those that tend to prefer dashboards say wait a a minute, you know, an overall rating is too simple. Like a school is not, can't be sort of

[01:23:37] given just a single grade or a single star rating. Like that does not capture all the nuance. We have all these multiple measures. You know, what if you're doing well on one, but not well on another, we need to see more. Also, I think there's a worry that schools that have low ratings in particular, if that will sort of stigmatize the school, demoralize school leaders, educators in the communities that they serve. And we definitely saw that sometimes over NCLB when like the paper would publish, here are all the failing schools. You know, that doesn't feel good to be teaching in a failing school and have your paper, like your local paper, write that up. So I think I just want to

[01:24:12] acknowledge those are sort of two valid arguments and two different sides. And there isn't a right answer. But for me, in my opinion, I would say the best systems actually do both. They provide an overall rating that is clear and user-friendly while also providing very specific information on every indicator and group of students in the dashboard.

[01:24:34] That there is a way, like this, it's presented as a dichotomy, but I actually think you can do both well and like they both present, both approaches have very valid reasoning behind it and you can try to sort of tap into the best of both worlds. So I want to show some examples of that, but first I just have to say the accreditation system does a very poor job of differentiating schools between other states. You know, I think accreditation wasn't really meant to serve as an accountability system, perhaps. That wasn't the origins of it. It has a different origin, and those are perfectly valid. It's identifying schools that

[01:25:11] are perhaps in significant distress, you know, that really need help, but 90% of schools are accredited. You look at other states. This is from data that we analyzed at All4Ed back in 2018, But, you know, in Ohio's case, they used an A through F grading system at the time.

[01:25:29] They've since moved to one to five stars. And you see there's this whole range of, you know, we have roughly 10% of our schools are getting A's. Then you have about 30% that are the B and C. You know, it just lets you sort of differentiate more between schools than a accredited, non-accredited situation.

[01:25:47] Back to one of your earlier points, then, if you don't mind, just a quick interruption. I think you said one of the purposes is to determine where resources flow. Does a place like Ohio change resources based upon the difference between an A, B, C, D, E, and F? Or a 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5?

[01:26:05] I mean, because I hear a lot of this, and I think, you know, when we put this system in place, what, 95, give or take, right? The theory was that resources would flow, and that if you made it clear, transparent to parents, parents would put pressure on the legislature, and the legislature would infect from resources.

[01:26:23] But, I mean, at the end of the day, we sort of have known which schools don't do well. We've known that for a long time. They're pretty much the same schools. And you haven't really seen the influx

of resources to those schools that I think the original system contemplated. And really, I think that you contemplated it in your opening remarks.

[01:26:40] Yes. And so, I mean, I understand the benefit of being transparent to parents. i am struggling with the next linkage that is resource flowing because we just really haven't seen that occur here i hear that and i will say one of our top priorities at all for ed is actually advocating for more school improvement funding for states because we think that is insufficient to meet student to meet school needs to meet student needs especially coming out of the pandemic so i mean basically we we can continue to tinker with the system but unless we change what the

[01:27:19] system what levers that system then pushes we really haven't accomplished anything i think though yeah resources like money is the most powerful tool obviously or money even if it's dedicated money right more teachers more specialists even if it's not just cash it's you have to dedicate these resources yeah but there's also attention i will say i mean that's something too that there is how do divisions spend their time which schools are the administrators focused on if they have you know reading coaches or reading you know which schools are getting more attention

[01:27:56] than others is also something that an accountability system can do even if it's just with current resources so in the case of most states it's how closely sort of their school rating system is linked to their school improvement system varies so indicate some states will say well all of our schools that get an f if they have an f grade system all of those are our comprehensive support schools well under federal law every comprehensive support school is eligible for extra title one funding and can sort of go for that that's the pot of funds that we are trying

[01:28:32] to get increased um through congress if we can other states make different choices and they may even have like state-specific school improvement funds so carry it one step further you live locally right i do okay so we talk about focusing on schools but then you've got let's say richmond as a division right how do you see a change in the accountability system helping richmond yeah i think so first of all it is giving better baseline information about school quality i think

[01:29:08] right now i will also just speak from anecdotal experience too i have you know a brother who is in the process of buying a house in richmond and he's going on zillow and redmond and he sees great schools ratings he's not seeing virginia department of education data he's seeing great schools and that's he's like well we're only looking at you know uh listings that have a great Great schools rating of this or above.

[01:29:32] We're not even considering the others. So I think improving the quality of information that is out there for the public is helpful in and of itself. I would also say, too, that I hope that RPS and the divisions around here are looking at data beyond what's in the accreditation system to actually make decisions about how they allocate resources, which schools might need extra counselors, which schools might need an actual reading coach.

[01:29:59] They have all this federal funding now, too, not just the state funding through the COVID recovery. How are they spending that? I would hope they are looking at their data, but the state kind of isn't providing much guidance, as much guidance there perhaps as other states are in terms of saying, here are the indicators, here's the data that we think is most important to focus on, and kind of aligning some of those local decision processes with the state process, if that makes sense.

[01:30:27] So that's, I think, one thing that I hope an accountability system could do, and it could also just provide that additional sort of clarity and support when you are able to also sort of see which schools are improving and which schools are sort of great and staying great and which schools are really struggling.

[01:30:51] and i think that's not something that sort of virginia has a handle on right now and able to differentiate it sort of like everyone if you have a system that's like good accredited you know really needing really needing additional help accredited conditions or accreditation denied but nothing here says great either like that's also something i think it's worth thinking about is like if you are in a school or a five-star school like that's something to celebrate that's something that i think people can really be proud of we often focus on sort of the low end but not high-end. At that point, though, doesn't your brother only go to the great schools and thus

[01:31:27] we increase segregation economically? He goes to great schools. I would love for Redfin to not post great schools and said, please see your State Department of Education's website. Here's the school report card. We can talk to Google about that. Can I ask two other questions?

[01:31:44] Yep. Okay. You've seen a lot of this. Right now, it seems to me, we measure how good a school is by basically how well kids do on standardized tests right which is not really a measure of how well the school is teaching as much as it is a measure of how much the kids know has anybody done a system that actually has measured growth in an appropriate way that is how effective the educational process is and is that replicable here yes i would say that is replicable that is

[01:32:19] doable um and that all comes down to skip ahead just a little bit i'm sorry well you keep going i'm sorry i took too much of your time i want to go back to where you were yeah yeah yeah i'm sorry it's like part of the reason it comes back to how do we weight growth and proficiency and one of the reasons why everyone likes growth is that it is less correlated with demographics than pretty much any measure that we have especially if you're using something like a student growth percentile as opposed to just like looking at changes in performance levels from like low below basic to high below basic um but if you're using something with like a student growth

[01:32:59] percentile it's far less correlated to student demographics than other measures so by choosing to weight growth in particular as a standalone measure more in the accountability system and using that as one of the key indicators to determine identification of schools for support that helps i think really get to this point of like what is the school's contribution to student learning right it's still important to measure proficiency it's still like that is still important but you can think about what's the appropriate weighting but at some point measuring proficiency i think what you're saying is really just another way of measuring demographics it does but i also

[01:33:37] have to say i think proficiency is important like i think it's important not arguing that point just making sure i understand what you're saying in our country you know with the it has been very highly correlated with student demographics you can't ignore that i will go back so yes your question your observations on michigan now that's an index versus that is an index yeah i wanted to show that as a different approach where instead of giving you know eight of f grades or one to five stars they do a 100 point index and it still is giving you more ability to differentiate between schools than just accredited accredited with predictions accreditation denied so you can see

[01:34:17] that sort of the average score is about 64 points. We sort of broke it up into quartiles. You can see the index does sort of skew a little bit higher. You know, only a quarter of schools or so are getting

fewer than half the points, but it still is able to give more nuance in terms of school quality than sort of a three buckets. So I think it's another valid approach worth considering, and many states use an index um a lot of states have an index for identifying schools and then like don't report the index score but um a state like michigan connecticut washington state where

[01:34:56] some of the other ones that we looked at in detail that used in indices michigan connecticut washington state washington state but there are many others if i may just on that follow up on that point so i'm not completely understanding that michigan but am i right that half almost half of their schools no it's not right half of the about yeah the the um average is 64 points but that half the sort of median is a little bit higher so does it meaningful meaningfully

[01:35:32] differentiate their schools i guess it's what i'm not understanding so we sorted them into quartiles um every school gets a score like you have 60 points you have 63 points you have 67 points 90 points um so there's a wide range of there is a wide range of values so in again in terms of how we allocate resources like if you think of the virginia accredited with condition schools as equivalent to the ohio f's you see those percentages are about the same am i not right

[01:36:05] that even within our accredited 89 schools are you know we have a red yellow green on multiple indicators and if you're not green on all those indicators then you there are requirements from the state uh for additional reporting and additional improvement plans and additional oversight um and especially on uh key literacy and math numeracy metrics so really we we do oversight for more than the 10 percent we do i think it's another i think that accreditation is 200 schools and i think we

[01:36:43] have another couple hundred schools that are engaged with in some way with our oversight system yeah and i think this is sort of in part of result a little bit of the way that essa is set up anyways with there is this focus on you need to be able to identify three categories of low performing schools so i wouldn't necessarily say that virginia isn't doing a good job of differentiating among its low support there is that sort of tail end that is accreditation with conditions or accreditation denied it's all the other schools are not necessarily getting as much

[01:37:18] differentiation is what you're seeing in other states where they have you know a fuller so identifying the high performers is one thing we're not doing you're not sort of distinguishing between the middle of the road versus hitting it out of the park and so can i a couple more questions on this point one is uh and i'll combine them and you can answer them one is what what is the research on the impact of school divisions that have gone to a single rating system versus a profile system?

[01:37:50] Is there any research on whether A through F works, for instance? I mean, that's the bottom line question, and then combined with that, and that may affect the research, is the states that have gone to an A through F or A through F-like system, what is the magnitude of the additional resources they have directed to the DF schools?

[01:38:13] because my fundamental question, if we were to go to an A through F system, how are we gonna attract and retain teachers to those schools? And we're not, I mean, right now we're already failing. We know who our DF schools are already, they're all in that 10%, and we are not doing anything at scale.

[01:38:35] We're not doing anything that is working to attract and retain great teachers to those schools. - No, I think those are very good questions, both of them. I will say the first question about research is that I don't know if something that has isolated that particular question, because typically when states are

changing their accountability systems, they're changing more than just going from, you know, a dashboard to having a summative rating.

[01:39:01] They're looking at, they change the indicators, they change the weighting, like they have a bunch of other changes. Generally speaking, though, one thing that is clear from the research is that there is a difference between accountability systems that are basically just reporting only. So accountability where we're reporting results versus accountability that actually has consequences in terms of additional resources or additional intervention from the state or sort of, you know, because you've been identified, you have some restrictions on your funding or you have to, you know, have more oversight, whatever it is. Systems that have some sort of consequence are more effective at improving student outcomes than systems that are

[01:39:40] merely reporting the information so that your second question about resources is a really critical one because if the response isn't sufficient then you're not necessarily going to see the results from the accountability system it will feel more just like we're reporting information but nothing is changing you know i'm not getting more resources or worse you're going to make things worse i mean we already have a huge crisis in how do we attract and retain great teachers to our high-poverty schools and if we start labeling more schools in these you know CDF I can just see that that I can't imagine how that doesn't

[01:40:17] exacerbate that problem unless they're the resource issue is addressed like a through F certainly isn't the only rating model there is the index states that you know I would say Washington I mentioned they don't do a 1 through 100 they actually put everybody into decile so it's you know you're sort of grouping similar schools together so on each indicator you get a different decile and then you've got an overall decile um so that's sort of one approach that perhaps feels a little bit it's relativistic in that you're sort of putting 10 of schools into each bucket but it is um a different approach you have

[01:40:54] you know star ratings you have some states do like color-coded buckets or sort of they have different like bullseye and like you're in the center of the bullseye or that there are a whole bunch of different ways of doing this and i think that's something that should be carefully considered probably across the board stakeholders everyone to think about well what if we want to have an overall rating what's sort of going to be the best balance of having that tension of you know we want to be accurate we want to be clear with parents and have this be something that people can understand without also you know necessarily making problems for us that already exist i would also say too

[01:41:32] that the conversation around school improvement resources i think is critically important and one that right now school divisions have a lot of money in part thanks to the federal government but that money is going to be you know after the 24 25 school year may not be around so i think one thing is encouraging school divisions right now to actually be spending those federal recovery dollars on school improvement efforts you know yes we also need to upgrade hvac systems that's a bad use of funds but really thinking about if you're a school right now that's accredited with conditions or you are you maybe you're fully accredited but your students have demonstrated

[01:42:11] significant losses in math or english language arts or are really struggling on other measures you're seeing higher chronic absenteeism rates you're seeing you know less student engagement, you know, really actually thinking about focusing on school improvement efforts with those funds and then trying to think about other ways that we can sustain that moving forward by looking at federal funds as well as, you know, additional state investment.

[01:42:39] Can I just one more? My last question is the, you know, Virginia actually adopted an A through F grading system you may remember back in, I think, 2013, 14 and the legislature adopted it and then the legislator repealed it uh before it ever went into effect and if i remember rightly one of the major considerations there was the frankly the realtors and the uh local land developers the the land use folks went berserk because they figured out in our i mean one of the big changes on an a3f system is

[01:43:14] not what's just happening at the df schools but the differentiation between the a and the b schools and in our fairfax counties and our high-end engaged um actively very hyper engaged parent communities your brother you know basically the real estate values in the b schools were going to plummet was their fear uh and the c's were going to go off the c's were all going to merge in with d's and f's so and that was going to increase segregation and reinforce the divides between haves and have nots what's the answer to that how do we how do the states that have done

[01:43:54] this have they had those problems and how they've addressed them i mean like i said i think the key is going to be thinking about how what measures you include and how and trying to get that balance right i mean as far as i know like i haven't heard crazy stories about you know dc has a one through five star system maryland has a one through five star system um many of our surrounding states i think north carolina does a through f grades you know i don't think virginia necessarily has fewer problems with school segregation than they do um with the same issues even though

[01:44:32] virginia has an accreditation system so i think that um that it certainly is important to think about that balance between how many schools do we sort of want to see this distribution like they they have in Ohio. Other states have different distributions. This is not the distribution across the board. You could say there's some states that identify more DMF schools. There's states that identify fewer or have more A's than this. So to think about that, think about communicating what these results mean, and think about the measures. Are we putting measures in that are basically highly correlated with demographics? Are we trying to put in some

[01:45:09] measures that really isolate the school's contributions to student learning? Do we want to emphasize those more so growth versus proficiency for instance right so getting the measures right and getting the resource right and that would be the question for jurisdictions that have done that have they what should what can we learn from them about resources and and measure metrics yeah yeah and I think in Florida for instance everybody talks about a to f but they also had an early literacy support they had choice they had a number of things that all happened so to Ann's point you can't disentangle but like they did a bunch of things and Like D.C. gives teachers more to teach in more challenging schools.

[01:45:45] So they're very like actively, if you're a good teacher in D.C. on their evaluation system and you're teaching in a high need school, you're like, yeah, exactly. Like the money is substantial now. And so I think like it goes to the extent to which this is a systems challenge and you can't just be like, we're going to do an accountability system.

[01:46:05] It's one of the other things that. And with our financing system that's so heavily weighted towards local property taxes, unlike D.C. where it's a single system, it's hard to, you know, we have to figure out how this, if we want to do that kind of resource allocation such that Richmond City can hire the best teachers away from the surrounding jurisdictions where her brother's kids are going to go because they're going to hire, in fact, your brother's going to move to the city and send his kid to the city schools because we're gonna hire the best teachers away from the counties to the city that we're so far

[01:46:45] from a funding system that that begins to address that that it's hard to hard to foresee how we get from here to there but it's a good place to aim yeah the accountability system cannot do it alone it really is about thinking sort of all the different pots of funds that exist whether it's early literacy programs or funds that are for professional development and teaching you everything i think if you have um states that have sort of thought about their accountability system kind of being the rock for everything and saying i remember talking to a state school superintendent once who says like yeah i tell all my teams like if they get a request from any school that is in

[01:47:23] comprehensive support and improvement they prioritize that request over others and that that's throughout all the divisions whether it's the cte division or the test the finance division like everybody knows that these are the districts that need extra support and we've like organized around that um so i think it requires thinking about the system as a whole but you sort of have to have to start somewhere um and i think there are a lot of interesting examples from other states i would say no states doing this perfectly um but i'm trying to sort of pull out sort of here's some interesting things that you could consider from other states even if there are parts of their

[01:48:01] system that i would say don't do that you know but definitely you have to do it holistically so i think some of the things that i would think about considering you know we have already talked about maybe having more than three levels to provide a little bit more differentiation weighting between growth and achievement so that you can really distinguish between you know places where students are meeting grade level expectations and making substantial progress differently from schools where students may not yet be at grade level standards but are making so much growth that they're catching up i think that would be really important to know especially

[01:48:38] now coming out of the pandemic and sort of the lost instructional time that we've seen that's a very different school than a school where students are not making grade level expectations and are not catching up like i want to offer different resources different interventions in those two schools um and so having a system that can differentiate between schools those different scenarios and where do you come down on like value-added versus student growth and how we should think about that because there's a whole nother we could go to a system where we start controlling for not just for prior student performance but we control for you know school and other and other characteristics and like how do you how do i spare that i think yeah just how

[01:49:17] do you think about how do you and how would you advise us to think because we we've we talk about growth a lot but there are other ways to do it how should we think about that yeah value-added as sort of the other most common measure, but I think it was often done in states that already had pretty sophisticated data systems to allow for that. The data sort of piece behind having a value-added measure is more complicated than a student growth percentile. I also tend to think student growth percentiles, I think, are more widespread in part because of the way value-added, frankly, was used in teacher evaluation and a lot of fears that if we adopt a value-added

[01:49:53] measure where you are trying sort of controlling more for um student characteristics to predict what growth they should be making in a given year and then see if they met that predicted growth or didn't like that's basically what a value added is that there was a lot of concern from teachers that this would all of a sudden put in teacher evaluations which we didn't see as much with student growth percentiles i also think student growth percentiles are easier to explain to the public um you know that's a

big piece here is you know i think a goal should be can we explain our accountability system on a single piece of paper um is it going to take 60 pages to explain

[01:50:32] this you know that might be a system that is super nuanced and super you know very thoughtful very considerate but then you are you know maybe not hitting that transparency point because there's a fear if you can't understand it but like oh you know how do i buy into this system if i don't understand how my school got an A or how my school became 30 points out of 50 points. If you can't figure that out, it really, I think, undermines public support for the system. But I would say it's something worth considering. You know, Tennessee uses a value-added measure, other

[01:51:09] states have used a value-added measure, but I think in many cases that was because they were using that type of data for a long time before it ever even became, you know, a topic of consideration for accountability systems. I think sort of already talked a lot about growth versus proficiency. So I'm going to go forward to at least show some examples. And this is from Maryland, which I thought was an interesting example of a state that I think is kind of doing both with having an overall rating and giving you some detailed information by indicator. So Maryland

[01:51:45] uses a five-star system. So four out of five stars right at the top, pretty easy to sort of But it's also not like super prominent. You know, it's not like four stars and nothing else. You immediately see the breakdown across each of the four indicators that they use: Achievement Progress, ELP, and then School Quality Student Success, how many points they're worth and how many points the district or the school in this case, excuse me, got on those indicators.

[01:52:13] So sort of explained they got 72% of points earned. Further down the page, it gives the break off for like how many points you needed to be four stars versus five. that is also there on this page okay and I'm sorry before you my understanding correctly the possible points achievement versus their weighting growth almost twice as heavily as achievement or interpret that when you look at it this way but I actually think not so quite so I also wanted to show this because they use a dashboard for individual indicators so if this is where they're using kind of both and you see here specifically that achievement versus progress measure.

[01:52:51] So it looks like it's more points, but actually some of the measures that are in academic progress are not growth measures, it's proficiency in science, and it's credit for a well-rounded curriculum. So if you're just looking at the growth measures, they're giving about 25 points to growth, that student growth percentile, and then there's actually about 25 points for achievement, if you include the science achievement.

[01:53:19] So it's more equal. I would say, which might be one criticism I would say of Maryland, is maybe consider putting more weight on growth. But I just thought this was an interesting example where you can see a state that has chosen to do an overall rating, but it's not sort of the only piece of information that's presented. I didn't have to click another page on the report card to find this. This was like all on the main page for the school and presents, I think, a lot of information. But in way you see that dashboard i see okay it's pretty easy to see that 12 points that's like a little

[01:53:54] bit more than half on that indicator and then i can click over and see more about what each of the measures were and how many points they got so i just thought that was an interesting example worth showing of kind of i don't think it's necessarily a choice of just doing a rating or just doing a dashboard you can incorporate elements of both it's been a very robust conversation before switching gears to student um

individual student subgroups and how they can be included any other um questions you'd like to ask about ratings or weighting of indicators um i just want

[01:54:31] to be sure i've had a very rich discussion so i want to be respectful of that if there are any questions all right so this is the final section so we're getting close to the end i know it's late afternoon um one thing i just really think it's important to us at all for ed and something that we have found is that this is a place where many states i think are not fully disaggregating their data when it comes to accountability systems and in some cases not including individual student groups at all in their school ratings or accountability so this is information that we

[01:55:07] found from 2018 again where 12 states those red states were not including information on individual groups of students at all they were just looking at all students data which is fine especially if you know are just trying to identify those comprehensive support schools again those are focused just on all students performance but i think we know in most states see huge achievement gaps that have only been exacerbated by the pandemic you know we know that students who are furthest from opportunity pre-pandemic are the ones that have struggled the most and so i think it's really important that accountability systems and those creating

[01:55:41] them think about how can we emphasize and include individual groups of students um in our accountability system so some states actually calculate separate ratings for individual groups of students and use them to identify schools for extra support sometimes those ratings are reported publicly sometimes they're not I'm just throwing that out there something states do not necessarily I encourage Virginia to do that but that was one way that states do this some states actually disaggregate all of their indicators but some just choose you know here's a single indicator that we're going to have that really looks at achievement gaps and

[01:56:16] differences between individual groups of students versus students overall and I i wanted to give some examples of both those things so here's north carolina kind of on the right you can see they um 2018-19 this school got a c but what these individual bars that are different colors represent is they actually gave a grade for every student group at the school on achievement so you see c b d c so those represent all different groups of students um it got cut off on the screenshot but another way more on the left that ohio did this is that they have a gap closing

[01:56:52] indicator so they use six different indicators some of them only measure all students um like early literacy is not looking at necessarily individual groups of students but their gap closing measure is really meant to focus on how are schools supporting um students who may be struggling and sort of trying to narrow achievement and opportunity gaps between different groups of students in the school one question that i think kind of hearkening back to some of the arguments against using ratings is that it's possible that an overall school rating could actually be masking the performance of individual groups of students so if you're giving an A through F or if you're giving a one to five stars is that

[01:57:31] really just reflective of um you know students overall but you might be missing a real problem in terms of students with disabilities in that school they're really struggling and need extra support um we did research at all for ed back in 2018 again looking at some states here's florida and louisiana both of which were giving a through f grades at the time and you can see sort of two very different scenarios. So in Florida's case, many of their highest performing schools actually had been identified for targeted support. So these are schools that are getting A's or B's. Yet on the

[01:58:09] other hand, the state was saying you have a consistently underperforming group of English learners or Latino students or student disabilities at this school. That's perhaps sending a conflicting message to parents when you have an A through F rating saying one thing, and then you have your school identification saying actually these A schools, these B schools really need extra resources because individual groups of students are struggling. I will say one of the reasons that that happened in Florida is because all D and F schools in Florida are identified for comprehensive support. Florida identified, I think, over 60% of their schools for support, so they didn't give themselves much room. They had to, if you were going to identify a school

[01:58:49] for targeted support, they had to have at least a C grade. So interesting choice that they made, but that was what happened um in louisiana on the other hand they had no schools that got an a who also were identified as needing to provide extra supports to an individual group of students and that was because they used a business rule they actually said you know if our school grade methodology works out so the school has an a but then we see that you have a consistently underperforming group um in that school where students disabilities or english runners are really struggling we're actually going to lower your grade to a b you can't get an a and so you

[01:59:24] you can sort of layer these business rules on top of a rating system to make sure that your identification system and your ratings are sending consistent signals i yes so where is virginia on that chart so virginia we didn't did not analyze because we did not so the accreditation system right now is not used to meet all the federal accountability system so because virginia didn't have a summative rating they were not one of the states that we analyzed so i i i will posit that

[02:00:00] we're i we do measure in we have indicators that are specifically focused on closing oh yeah for all this there's definitely i would say virginia falls in the cap category i would say sort of like an ohio of having a gap closing indicator for i think that's where we would be yeah and that in virginia's case i will say at least right now all of the schools that are identified for the federal groups you know that targeted support additional target support comprehensive support all of them come from some of the departments here when correct me I think none of them are accredited so the issue in Florida none

[02:00:38] of them are fully accredited correct they are all coming from that sort of ten percent of schools right so in this case I would say Virginia if you're considering the current accreditation system kind of like a summative rating Virginia is not in the Florida camp of, here are schools that are fully accredited yet have a consistently underperforming group of students with disabilities and a consistently underperforming group of Black students. That's not happening in Virginia, but I wanted to point this out in case Virginia does move to a new different system, that this is something to keep in mind, that school identification, particular identification, because individual groups

[02:01:18] of students are struggling, should hopefully be consistent with the overall system here. spending great point through shifting to a slightly different point i just wanted to point this out that states have been selecting lower end sizes and again this is sort of a technical rule of how many students need to be enrolled in a school from an individual group in order for that group to count for accountability purposes in virginia's case it's 30 students so if there are 28 students with disabilities in a school students with disabilities are not included for accountability

[02:01:57] systems. They just fall away. Virginia is one of only eight states that has an end size above 25. Most of the country has moved more toward end sizes from 11 to 25. That's where the majority of states

are, but there are a few that set an end size of 10 or less. I will say Virginia uses an end size of 10 for reporting. So in that case of the school that had 28 kids with disabilities, kids with disabilities may not be considered as a separate group for accountability purposes, but data is reported on the report card for students with disabilities. The reason I wanted

[02:02:33] to raise this is this is actually from Virginia's ESSA plan, the plan that Virginia submitted. So because of the N size Virginia included, this is older data, so these numbers may have changed, but at least at the time that meant that more than half of schools in Virginia could not be held accountable for the performance of English learners, Hispanic students, or Asian students, and more than one-third of schools cannot be held accountable for Black students or students with disabilities that is because the n size is 30 that is how many schools are excluded from even being considered for targeted support because of student performance for those groups

[02:03:20] i think it's a significant it's one of the biggest concerns i have and i think it's yeah and it also is an excellent reason why separating accreditation from accountability is a good move because if your accreditation could be at stake for 30 kids that that is a whole different mindset than if reporting an end in the 15 students so again i i i'm glad i got back here from my quick break in time for the small end discussion i think again that's another reason

[02:04:00] to separate so you can use a smaller end with less risk right and i think especially if you think about one of the main purposes of accountability being mustering resources and additional resources you know it there's a good you know half of schools that may have english they may have 20 english learners at that school but they will never be able to be identified for targeted support on behalf of their english learners even if they're struggling and potentially get extra title one funding to help them like it's not about shaming the school or blaming the school it's about triaging and finding you know identifying the schools that need those extra supports

[02:04:39] and need extra help and virginia does use an n size of 10. i mean i think the argument has been well we need to have these high n sizes because we need to be so sure that if we're identifying a school as needing support that it absolutely needs us you know if if that school and i think this comes from like nclb era where you know the consequences were perhaps a little more drastic where nclb said you know you missed adequate yearly progress for five years you face restructuring and you know so i think there was a desire to be very careful about you know let's not over identify i

[02:05:15] think the risks of over identifying are slightly lower now that we've moved more to a less punitive more supportive accountability structure and like i think it's true these students are basically invisible right now in the accreditation system um or in the accountability system excuse me um so i think it's something that could easily be changed or it's definitely worth considering changing um virginia does use the n size of 10 for reporting and would bring virginia more in line with where other states are like i said only eight states in the country and that was in 2018

[02:05:48] used in n size as large as virginia's so one of the things that strikes me as i've been listening is just what you said was we we the whole purpose of the system is to drive support to help schools that really needed. And honestly, I think the word accountability to the non-policy minded individual does nothing to convey that. In fact, it actually reinforces the opposite.

[02:06:21] And I'm reminded of this conversation because as we were thinking about the buckets, the categories that we were looking at sort of naming for the early childhood bqb5 system you talk about a

sector that is really under duress under resource underfunded and here comes accountability that's going to say you need to be doing a b c d and we we were very adamant about the language that needed to be used if the goal was to say it's about support right and and i don't

[02:06:57] think that the public understands that as the intent i think when you hear accountability you hear you're either doing it or you're not and if you're not doing it i don't want to have anything to do with that i don't know and understand that you're actually getting support i nobody's talking about how that's happening or so the the language does you know warrant some contemplation if the goal is really to get people to stop being fearful of these systems and what they what they translate

[02:07:32] sort of in everyday you know life i don't know how we deal with that but it is a conundrum that i think really the unintended consequences that come with it that ann and others have articulated around i'm going on the website i know exactly what i'm going to do when i'm getting ready to buy a house, I'm going to find the place that's not in that situation if I can afford to do that.

[02:07:59] That's just, that's the reality. That's like, that's, we're not changing that. We're not changing that behavior. So I really think it would be interesting to contemplate, to be curious about, is there another way to talk about accountability and what this system is intending to do?

[02:08:19] Right. I mean, all the underlying mechanics could be the same, but it's how you communicate it, how you talk about it, how you emphasize the support and the resources and make that really clear. I also hope too, I mean, I think we've been focusing a little bit more in the most recent discussion about those lower performing schools, the ones that are really struggling who do need significant extra resources. But it also, I think, would hope that with an accountability system, and there actually was like a whole series, I forget who wrote but they had several guest authors they were i think it was called the a word it was all about like how can we we're using accountability and it is considered to sort of be punitive but like is

[02:08:57] there another way we could talk about this or just label it that would more accurately reflect what these systems actually do but i would hope that even our highest performing schools our schools that are those five stars or those a schools are getting 95 of points you know they're looking at this data too and thinking about how can we continuously improve you know getting an a doesn't mean that you're doing everything right and that every student in the school is going to have what they need so it's really i think about having that continuous improvement mindset for everyone but then being sure that districts and the state department of ed and sort of school divisions know as well that they really need to be providing additional help and resources

[02:09:37] to those that are super are lower performing whilst maybe some of those higher performing schools can do that continuous improvement process on their own. They have the tools, the resources to do it, but everyone should be engaging in that. We'll move on to other issues around groups of students besides NCISE. I will just say English learners was another topic that I wanted to specifically focus on in part because the way that Virginia accreditation currently includes English learners is inconsistent with federal law. So if Virginia wanted to move to assist a new accountability,

[02:10:16] whatever word we call it system that could be used both for sort of state priorities but also for federal purposes um virginia right now says that the english learner scores on state assessments can be excluded from accreditation for five years i believe is this wrong just i wanted to clarify small areas for

accreditation the rules are different yes students over three years oh good okay so it's three years thank you i appreciate that sure yeah the data here like i said this

[02:10:49] was in virginia's consolidated essa plan it's from that was submitted in 2017 so this data could have changed it would be interesting to get a more current analysis and to get one that sort of compares the accreditation that's averaged over three years versus the single year because that is something you can do to try and increase the number of schools that could be considered and sort of meet that end size and say well we're going to look at multiple school years so we have more student data to pull from. That's something that some states do. And I'm sure this is something that in Wyoming, you have a lot of, you had a lot of small schools, so you probably had to do some things to get the end size up for different, different school divisions in order to meet it.

[02:11:29] And that's on English learners. I think for accreditation there, an English learner can be excluded for five years. So that means for those academic assessment scores, their results just aren't considered federal law would not allow a state to do that federal law says that recently arrived english students um their scores on state assessments can be excluded for accountability purposes for one to two years there are different options there's sort of one option that's a one year exclusion option and one that's a two year um because you sort of phase in the first year

[02:12:08] it's growth and then the second year proficiency so it takes two years for them to be fully included but recently arrived english learners are students who have been enrolled in u.s schools for one year or less. So there's a big gap between five years and one year. So I think that's just something I wanted to flag as if Virginia was moving forward and thinking about adopting a different accountability system that for this to meet federal purposes, more English learners would need to be included than are currently included in accreditation. And I will also say, you know, this gives some heartburn because I understand English learners have a lot of additional

[02:12:46] challenges you're not just learning academic content but you're also needing to learn a new language um and sort of potentially if you're coming from you know additional trauma if you're an asylum seeker you know there's a whole lots of diff of very um challenging issues with english learners and they need a lot of extra resources um and it's one of the only sort of categories that is really defined by we talk about english learners who we know just by definition of being an English learner, you require some additional support. I wouldn't say that's true of black students or of Hispanic students or white students or Asian students. They could be, that's not sort

[02:13:24] of built into the definition. But ESSA permits English learners to be included in the subgroup for up to four years after they've been reclassified. So the English learner subgroup doesn't just include current English learners, who you would assume are, you know, really having to struggle with learning a language as well as learning academic content, but it allows you to include students for accountability purposes who have been reclassified, who actually have met the English language proficiency standards and are now, you know, able to fully be integrated, you know, not need those extra support services. It's also really important because previously,

[02:14:03] before ESSA under NCLB, there was a whole separate accountability system for English learners under federal law in Title 3. ESSA did away with that and put all accountability for English learners into Title 1. And that's why there is now that required indicator for English language proficiency in federal law as part of the main school accountability system. And so I think that sort of making this

change to better align Virginia accreditation with federal accountability around English learners is another really important step that would need to be taken if as the board moves forward here and I also just wanted to point out because I thought this was

[02:14:41] really interesting that you could even go above and beyond ESSA in the case of Washington State they actually have identified and use a special business rule specifically to try and drive additional supports to schools that are struggling to support English learners the growing population of students in their state and they said you know in addition to sort of just schools that have a consistently underperforming group of students being placed on targeted support if you have consistently low English language learner progress you could be eligible for tier 2 support which is sort of their middle category they call them tier 1 2 & 3 instead

[02:15:16] of additional targeted support targeted support comprehensive support and improvement but because of that they identified significantly more schools as needing to provide extra support for English learners than other states that we looked at so I just thought it was something interesting and a a unique thing that we didn't see in other states so i'm moving forward just for come no surprise but i think some considerations around ways to better include all different students in school accountability systems is thinking about ensuring that schools with the highest ratings are not sort of also identified for improvement because they have a consistently struggling group

[02:15:55] of students so making sure that the system is sending consistent signals about overall student performance as well as individual groups of kids, lowering the end size for school accountability, and getting some more up-to-date data on sort of how many schools may be excluded from accountability for particular groups of students, and then including English learners more consistent with federal requirements. And that means, you know, taking that ELP indicator out as a standalone measure, you know, so that students, English learners, English language progress is considered

[02:16:29] alongside their academic abilities um and you know can think about including them you know not giving them sort of five years you know for a kid in elementary school like an english learner might not be included at all they're not included again in the accreditation system until they're in sixth grade um so definitely checking in on them before that so that is the end i really appreciate i know we have probably gone way over time although i haven't seen emily or anybody else waving me off or no music was playing like at the oscars for me to leave um and i'm happy to answer any additional

[02:17:06] questions um follow up with resources and i hope this has been useful yeah i think it's been fascinating honestly so thank you so much for you know spending the time with us i know it's hard to sit and talk for that long also so no it's fine this is my favorite one of my favorite topics so when emily reached out i was i was definitely game for it and just appreciate all your thoughtful comments and questions. It's not an easy task at all. And there are a lot of different trade-offs to consider. But I think it's really, like I said at the beginning, it's a great time to be

[02:17:41] having these conversations, given where we are coming out of the pandemic, seeing the impact of lost instructional time on students, especially our students of color, students from low-income backgrounds, students with disabilities, and just, you know, sort of that this system has kind of of been on pause for a few years and so when the system has been paused it's sort of a natural time to re-examine it and to think about is could this work better for our kids okay so do you have any states that would be the best examples of linking resources to the system so i mean i think florida

[02:18:17] is an interesting example i will say there's some things in florida about their consequences i don't love as much but i think in terms of the resource side of things um they're a good state to look at um tennessee would be another i think that it does a pretty good job of linking the resources with the accountability structure and sort of doing some of those things at the state level to try and unify everything behind it um so those are two that come to mind that i will if i think of others and when those systems were put in place did they work with the local boards

[02:18:52] basically or the state boards work with the legislature on a complete package or did the accountability piece just sort of occur without legislative input and then we went looking for legislative help florida definitely had legislative involvement um but i can't recall in tennessee tennessee might have been more um they the legislature has been involved in certain aspects of it but they may have also had the board more involved as you know state governments governance is differs from state to state for sure um i guess what i'm looking to be sure of is if we

[02:19:28] you know when we embark down this path that we do it in a way that maximizes the chance that resources will flow with ratings no i think that that is one of the things that was really interesting with essa implementation is that there were all these new like stakeholder engagement requirements of here are all the stakeholders that need to be consulted and governors kind of had an outside new role and were sort of shouted out is like needing to provide even more um consultation than perhaps some other stakeholder groups but i don't think state legislators were sort of given the same due and so i would think about as the board considers this ways to

[02:20:08] get some of the legislative leaders um into discussions as well as local school board members and you know the governor's office too because ultimately i think the states would have the strongest accountability systems are those where everybody is aligned behind it and believes in it as opposed to and you know was consulted early on not just as an afterthought

[02:20:28] And I think that if it's never hard to, it's never easy, I should say, to reach consensus across, it can take more time, but I think ultimately it helps these systems also be more politically sustainable, especially, you know, administrations change, partisan control of state legislators changes, board members change over, you know, so I think building a system that has buy-in from all different entities, I think is the way to go.

[02:20:57] while keeping in mind that like the role of these different entities also needs to be respected. The board has a different role than the legislature. Sometimes states maybe have gotten in trouble by being so specific in their state law about what the accountability system requires that when the federal law changed, their state system was no longer federally compliant and they had a really hard time going back and changing that. It actually happened in Florida's case where their state system didn't fully include english learners in the way that esso required and so they had to sort

[02:21:33] of go through some things on the back end to get their state plan approved where they couldn't change their state a through f grade system but they had to add some additional features just to meet federal requirements so i think that's a further down the line consideration but thinking about if there is going to be legislation the sort of the level of detail so that it's flexible enough to be changed over time well i guess when i talk about bringing the legislature and you know here the legislature stays forever the governor's coming over every four years right so a little bit different power dynamic in virginia than it is in most other places uh you know like i said i

[02:22:11] i appreciate the goal of informing parents as to what's going on but i more appreciate the goal of moving resources so that we help those kids where they're where it's needed and so for me the concept of buy-in is how do i get a system how do we get a system here that actually will have resources flow to the places that are identified as needing them because it can only that just hasn't happened yet here you know there's the seven percent required set aside of title one funds but that's insufficient to support all the schools so there needs to be

[02:22:47] state resources i realize i overstate it when i say none but there's not near enough is a fair statement. Dr. Seabrook? So I'm going to ask you a question. You're given a lot of fantastic. Thank you very much. Lots of good stuff here. I'm going to ask you about actually the tests used in some states that are doing a good job, and here's why. The states historically that used value-added measures were largely states that had pre-existing statewide growth systems, in many cases MAP, that enabled them to have in place value-added systems. At the time, Virginia had to use two

[02:23:23] and growth percentiles to check the box for our funds, our assessments had kind of had a ceiling and a floor, and so that really confounded our SGP analysis and led to a whole lot of justified skepticism. Now, our assessments have evolved over time, and so maybe there's a little more stretch there to help make that a little bit better tool. But, you know, Virginia, I think, you know, at the time, wisely decided to stick with our own standards, and we didn't hitch our wagon to a Common Core train. However, that we did miss out on some of the things that happened over the past decade in terms of evolution of assessments.

[02:23:56] So since we're not Common Core, we didn't do Smarter Balanced, but we still are largely architecturally in 1990s approach to assessment, what states have modernized their assessments that have done good work there that might be something we could look at?

[02:24:11] Because ultimately, if the people in the field don't have faith in the test itself, everything else is a house of cards. So who's doing a good job in the assessment area? Yeah, I mean, I will say I am skeptical of states that have, I understand why they've made the choice, but I do not think that choosing the ACT or SAT as your high school assessment is perhaps the best choice.

[02:24:36] I just have concerns that it's not well aligned to state assessment, to state standards, because it wasn't designed to do that. It was designed for a different purpose. That has been a popular choice. sort of exclude all those states as ones i would not necessarily recommend um looking at i think there's a lot of the changing landscape around assessment um is different but for the most part um states have figured out a way to use student growth um typically a student growth percentile not a value added um yeah i think of course it's often taught a bit like massachusetts

[02:25:13] their assessment system um you have states like um i think i've been a fan of louisiana's cannabis not they use act in high school but i think they're k8 and they've also done a really interesting job with providing and trying to provide aligned interim assessments free of charge to districts so instead of you know relying on that map growth it's like well here's this like standards aligned assessment that we've helped build that you can use for free you know here it is so that's another state that um i think has done some interesting work in the assessment space they're also

[02:25:49] doing some innovative assessment work um so i think one of the things too is that you know there's virginia has its growth measure now and like i said it's not you know awful it's it's serving a purpose um but as assessment contracts are expiring and sort of being refreshing and putting out a new rfp for

them i would think about trying to put out an rfp that would move be able to allow for better student growth percentile or some sort of student growth data um because that is something that nearly all states have been able to do um i think it's over

[02:26:27] 40 included growth um and typically not in like a just you move to performance level way that was an incomplete but if i think of others too this is off the off the top of my head yeah i have a question you said something that was intriguing and it piqued my curiosity you said there's elements of florida that you don't like and i was curious because florida sort of changed my thinking on this because some stuff that was sort of commonly held wisdom was disproved that i including that i thought it was probably plausible was disproved so when you said that i was like

[02:27:02] super curious and i haven't read their state law recently so for all of i know that this could have changed but i think especially knowing the virginia context like one of the things with florida that i recall is that if you were in f school for i think it was two years i don't think it was one i think it was two years that you could your you could be converted to a charter after two years i think that's not something that's really right right workable in virginia and not something that i would necessarily say is like something i would recommend other states adopt because i think that that necessarily didn't you know it was it was very florida specific as opposed to something

[02:27:39] that would virginia would make sense so that was what i was thinking about was more of the they had some kind of very extreme punitive consequences around school governance and they kicked in after only like one or two years as opposed to eight years or six years right okay the evaluations did find that was interesting this is actually which part of which found that that had a salutary effect which i was surprised to see that and like calder and other you know research outfits have found that that has that that had a pod that that had a positive effect on behavior along with the the grades which both of which surprised me was not what i expected to

[02:28:18] see no i agree i think it's just the virginia context here versus the florida concept was totally different thank you yeah thank you so much for being with us i appreciate it it's good to see you yes and uh i'm happy to follow up their questions my contact information is here um it's been a real pleasure to be with y'all and thank you for hanging in there i know it's been a long day and being the last presentation is always yeah you're not the last we actually have

[02:28:53] another four we have another four or five hours to go i don't all right well hopefully there's dinner at some but before we start that we're going to take a quick 10 minute break if that's

[02:29:02] okay with everybody thank you very much very helpful thank you uh emily do i turn it over to

[02:42:02] you or do the timeline for revision i guess you know the board had asked that uh the department would come up with what would be required to separate out the accountability and accreditation systems, whether it's strictly at our level, whether it requires legislative changes, et cetera, regulatory change.

[02:42:24] So I'm hoping that although this says timeline, what we're really going to hear in part is what the mechanics would have to look like, who's going to have to be involved. Sure. Okay. Good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President, ma'am, members of the board and Superintendent Bailo, as President Gecker mentioned, we're before you today to present a proposed timeline for potential revisions to Virginia's accreditation and accountability systems.

[02:42:49] At the October 19th meeting, a motion passed requesting the superintendent to report on the steps necessary to bifurcate the accreditation and accountability system to create a system of accreditation that separates legal compliance from accountability. Our presentation today will outline the necessary steps to separate the two systems on an expedited a timeline to meet Governor Youngkin's expectations of a new accountability system by next school year, as he outlined in a November 22nd statement.

[02:43:19] Let me get the right slide up there. Based on statements made by board members, Superintendent Bailo, and the governor, we have outlined the following priorities that would go into a new accountability and accreditation system. I certainly don't want to sit here.

[02:43:35] It's late in the afternoon. I don't want to sit here and read the slides to you, but some of the highlights obviously would be to have the accreditation system be a measure of compliance what we currently consider to be pre-accreditation that is outlined in the current soa and accountability as a measure of school performance based on student outcomes to start the process of bifurcating the two system changes to state statute would be required and i know that president gecker you had that question

[02:44:10] last month on whether those changes would be necessary throughout the code there are numerous references to accreditation that would need to be corrected. At the direction of Superintendent Baylow, staff has submitted a legislative proposal to the governor's office outlining the necessity of such legislation to make these changes.

[02:44:31] Certainly we're before you today to host a work session to talk through the timeline as well as the necessity for any kind of emergency regulations moving forward. legislation is required to change code references staff can begin drafting emergency regulations on a new accountability system for the board to consider 2.2 dash 4,011 of the code states that regulations that an agency finds are necessitated by an emergency situation may be adopted upon consultation with the Attorney General which approval shall be granted only

[02:45:07] after the agency has submitted a request in writing at the nature of such emergency and that will be at the sole discretion of the governor all emergency regulations are limited to no more than 18 months in duration and if the agency wishes to continue regulating the subject matter beyond the 18-month limitation a regulation to replace the emergency must be promulgated and that will have to take the standard regulatory process any questions on that

[02:45:40] part just a clarifying question at this point we can talk more later about them But the clarifying question if I understand correctly the emergency regs if this process goes through as Soon as we adopt I mean the emergency regs go into effect essentially right away Correct as soon as they are filed with the registrar's office the emergency regs would become effective So this proposal this proposal is to adopt changes by March or April of this year That would then go into effect immediately for next school year

[02:46:15] But then you they only last for 18 months. So you have to come through the regular and regulatory process to back them up That is correct. And in this in this emergency regulation situation This is promulgating new a new accountability system the current standards of accreditation would still remain in place until Changes to the regulatory system as well as code changes were made by the legislature and the regulatory changes would be made by the board Can we back up for a minute? I'm not quite sure You know, you'll pardon the lawyer in me now.

[02:46:49] Okay. What changes have to be made to the code in order to separate out the systems? I know you said that some references have to be corrected. I'm not sure I would tell the assembly they need to correct things. But what exactly are we mandated to do now, or is the system mandated to be now, and what has to change in that in order to bifurcate?

[02:47:14] This is why I have a whole host of people up here to phone a friend. I'm not sure, Leslie or Shelly, if you all can answer that off the top of your head, or if I can start to point to some specifics. Sure, I can start to provide a little bit, and I'm sure Shelly can fill in the gaps, as I know this particular section of the code language really guides her work.

[02:47:36] Probably the biggest part is in Standard 3 of the Standards of Quality, which outlines the accreditation system for the Commonwealth, and sets out a lot of parameters for what needs to be included in the accreditation model. here we have references to growth and proficiency and items like that that kind of give the structure and mechanical pieces of accreditation so with with the specificity and how prescribed accreditation is in the code we would need that that to be revised and either probably really just a change in nomenclature about what we're talking about with growth and proficiency and there's other measures really referring to accountability under this new redesigned framework but shella if there's

[02:48:16] any other specificity you want to put right there i think most of it is in standard three but because accreditation is really used to be turn your mic on hold it down there we go

[02:48:39] teacher voice okay all right let's try this is that better yeah okay so most of it is in standard three um but there is also language in the funding formulas that deal with accreditation so essentially what we're talking about is accreditation is now really accountability so many in many cases it would just be replacing the words but because it is in so many places in the code it will require a detailed review and revision to the necessary

[02:49:11] sections and while we have submitted uh potential proposals to the governor's office for consideration around the necessity to need to do this we have not gone through the entire code section to make sure that we have captured every single place where it would need to be changes but it it would be numerous changes can i ask a process question mr president i just want to make sure to miss holton's question i want to make sure i'm tracking this the both the authority and any regulations that are promulgated under the authority expires in 18 months. So we then, so like if we make a,

[02:49:51] if you, under this authority, you make some kind of regulatory change. If you want it to be permanent, you then need to also at the same time or subsequently start through the normal regulatory process, which can be the same regulation, but to make it conformist. So everything expires after 18 months, unless you, okay. There is a provision that if the agency has done everything in its power to meet the 18-month deadline and has not been able to do so.

[02:50:16] You can get a six-month extension at the sole discretion of the governor, but you have to show that you have taken the steps and the process to meet that 18-month deadline. Are you planning on showing us all the things that need to be changed and explain what that will mean? We're not prepared to do that today. I mean, are you confident there's legislative buy-in to this?

[02:50:50] does anybody talk to anybody? I appreciate the governor's desire. I'm asking, is there anything in here that's going to be controversial for the legislature? And if we change the statute, do we have issues

if final regs don't come on time, if we're going to rely on emergency regs?

[02:51:12] Yeah. I defer back to Superintendent Bailo. I personally haven't had any communication with any legislators. Yeah. Thanks, Emily. And Mr. President, A GREAT QUESTION AND OF COURSE NO ONE CAN PREDICT HOW THINGS MIGHT MOVE THROUGH THE LEGISLATURE.

[02:51:29] THAT SAID, CERTAINLY THE GROUNDWORK IS BEING LAID BOTH PUBLICLY WITH LEGISLATURES AS WELL AS INDIVIDUAL CONVERSATIONS, NOT MYSELF BUT FROM THE SECRETARY'S OFFICE AND THE GOVERNOR'S POLICY TEAM. OKAY.

[02:51:46] MS. HOLTON. I'M NOT SURE WHETHER THIS IS THE RIGHT TIME TO DO THIS OR LATER IN THE CONVERSATION, BUT I UNDERSTAND THE -- I THINK I UNDERSTAND THE NOMENCLATURE CHANGE, USING THE WORD accountability instead of accreditation, but I assume that this is about something more or different than that, right?

[02:52:03] I assume we're not going through on an emergency basis and doing all of this just to change the word. So do we have any sense of what are we, are we just, are our current yellow, green, yellow, red indicators and growth and proficiency and how all that translates to accreditation status, what are the key elements of the substantive system that are being proposed to be changed, or are we just gonna take that whole existing system and call it accountability, or are we changing something in it?

[02:52:37] - Yeah, that's another question that I would defer to Superintendent Balow. I'm not sure what the board is gonna be interested in keeping from the current system to carry forward, from current accreditation system to carry forward in the accountability system. If they wanna carry every indicator forward, if they want to add additional indicators, I certainly think it would be up to the board to talk about what indicators should be in an accountability system?

[02:53:03] - I just have trouble understanding, and obviously, Superintendent Balo, this is gonna be an extended conversation, but at some point, to understand why it's an emergency, I need to understand, well, first of all, what are the substance of things we're trying to change? I mean, nomenclature, that's not an emergency, but if there's some substantive things we're trying to change, what are they, And how are they, how do we understand them to be, what's the nature of the emergency?

[02:53:31] Well, the emergency is the pandemic learning loss, I assume. But how are any of the accountability changes that are up for grabs, you know, how do we connect them? I mean, to me, the thing that's most obviously connected to pandemic learning loss is teachers and getting students in the, teachers shortages and chronic absenteeism.

[02:53:54] but if there are things that the department recommends to us or that the board members think or things about our accountability system that have contributed to some of our crises. In other words, help me understand what's the emergency and what are the things we're trying, what are we trying to fix?

[02:54:15] - So great question. And you know from your time as secretary and first lady that emergency rules is a little bit of a misnomer in terms of is it an emergency like a state of emergency? And the answer is no. Emergency rules allow an agency to engage in rulemaking on a fast track process while simultaneously doing the regular process so that rules can be implemented sooner while still going through all of the public scrutiny in the entire process that regular rulemaking goes through.

[02:54:49] It is, you know, been communicated among board members as well as the governor's office that an accountability system, we'd like to see it be in place in schools next fall. And the only way to do that is with emergency rulemaking on whether it's nomenclature or whether this board decides that it's more substantive suggestions to the legislature to go forward in rules or legislation to make sure that we have the ability and the flexibility to stand up, to carefully and thoughtfully stand up

[02:55:28] an accountability system for the beginning of the 23-24 school year. And we can't do that with the regular 18-month rulemaking process. - How do you get something through the legislature when the question is gonna be what are the regs you're gonna put behind this without having the regs we're going to put behind this in other words let's assume that the goal is to go to an adaf just because we had that presentation the legislature is going to want to know before they make all these changes you know what the regs will look like because again with adaf

[02:56:05] specifically i mean it's not particularly the composition of this legislature but it has been there before and has you know was passed and then the mandate failed if you will was repealed so it'd be helpful to me to understand what the end game is you know as much as understanding you know what the process is to get to the end game right so again uh you know we heard in the jlark report last week we're going to hear throughout the um the legislative session we heard from the governor we heard on here um you know while emergency rule making is um is is a word and

[02:56:43] maybe sometimes a misnomer in some situations we do have an educational emergency on our hands right now with our NAEP scores we have the the steepest declines of fourth grade reading in the nation since 2017 and 2019 in math we have the steepest declines in fourth grade math from 2017 to today our sol scores all of our indicators suggest that the learning loss is an emergency so that aside having transparency with data having transparency with our accountability system um and and creating

[02:57:19] the factors in the system that we just heard from ann a few minutes ago um really is setting the stage for doing that so i know that doesn't get that doesn't get at exactly what your question is however this this presentation today this um this board asked us to come up with a plan and a timeline for bifurcating accountability and accreditation so right now those are the legislative changes um that that will be proposed is how do we separate accreditation from

[02:57:54] accountability so that accreditation is a box checking exercise to make sure that schools are compliant with um with what is in code and that the legislature has an opportunity to weigh in on the transparent system of accountability via legislation that that we um that that we want to embark on and so it's really articulating in legislation uh what that bifurcation looks like to the general assembly if i may just i don't have any concept of what that transparent system

[02:58:30] of accountability that you want to embark on is and um until i understand that better i don't know i had to go forward on any of this and also you know how do we connect that to our current uh crises as you've i mean frankly the most obvious uh decline is fourth grade reading right and the most obvious answer to that is implement the virginia literacy act with fidelity and and speed what what says what what do you want to do to the accountabilities is it an a through f grading

[02:59:04] system you want to do and and if so how do you connect that to what our problems are yeah i wish there was a a silver bullet like implementing the virginia literacy act i think that's profound i think it's huge but it's not the only thing that needs to go into place um you know having a system of accountability

that truthfully and transparently lets the public in schools and school divisions and communities know where schools are performing know um in in a in a very uh simple and clear way

[02:59:37] again as we heard last month from excel in ed as we heard today from ann um hyslip am i saying her name correctly andy hyslip um that that we want to um to ensure that an accountability a robust accountability system presents the information to the public into school districts um in a in in a transparent and comprehensive way and that is part of the equation and that is part of the the solution to the emergency that we're facing.

[03:00:07] - So let's assume for a minute that the accountability system highlights the fact that we've had significant learning loss, the fact that we know we're a failure to learn. What is the state proposing? What is the BDOE gonna propose to, and you know, we talked about this a little bit in the context of the annual report, right?

[03:00:25] Two problems, one is sort of the major systemic problem, the second is the COVID cohort, right? What is gonna be proposed to advance the COVID cohort that level that we need them to be do you i just want to clarify mr president do you i mean are you asking about the the accountability system that we'll be proposing no assume for a minute that the accountability system shows what we have just reported on what you know we gave press conferences on which is we have significant learning loss nape scores fell so we know we have significant

[03:01:02] issues in the system and we know that they're largely system-wide right and we can isolate through some of the SOL testing, you know, who got hit more. But by and large, if you look at the JLOC report, you know we have a problem. So assume that the accountability system or a system has picked that piece up. The second question is, what do you do with it? So what is the administration, what is the BDOE's proposal for how do we deal with bringing those kids who were most hurt during COVID up to where they ought to be? Because that's a resource question. And, you know, it's,

[03:01:36] We talk about the need for transparency and information, but frankly, we already know we got a problem, and we know pretty much where that problem is. A new system is not going to change the fact we have a problem, and it's not going to tell us any more about where it is.

[03:01:52] What are we going to do about it? I would disagree a little with that, Mr. President. I don't think we have a clear understanding or a clear baseline, and I'm all for the presentation this morning. It was great in the work that Jen is doing on the Literacy Act, but it's going to take more than that. We have the potential of really having a lost generation of kids if we're not, and it's going to take a bunch of things.

[03:02:12] And I think there's a common ground. We talk about accountability and resources as if these things are at odds. I think there's a lot of common ground here, but I don't think we have a common back base across the Commonwealth. I think there's still a lot of confusion.

[03:02:28] I don't think parents are getting good information. So I actually think there is a case to be made that we need to relatively quickly change how we are communicating this. I have some concerns to make sure we get this right because this is definitely a measure twice, cut once kind of thing and on the authority.

[03:02:45] But I think there is a case there and using this broader definition of an emergency that it fits under. The difficulty I have with that, Andy, is that too often on the political side of the spectrum, I don't

mean the legislative political side of the spectrum, you will enact something and say, I've solved the problem.

[03:03:07] I am concerned greatly that we will change the accreditation system and still not solve the problem. That is, we will never see the resources that need to flow based upon what the data identifies to fix the underlying issue.

[03:03:23] You're right. I agree, Mr. President. That is a risk, but we're not going to fix it if we keep telling people that 90% of the schools are fine and we have school divisions saying that there's not a problem with learning loss. So you may be right, and it would be a tragedy if we enact this and we don't get these other things.

[03:03:38] but not doing anything doesn't solve that problem where we are now I'm not sure when's the time that I do have a couple I don't know I may be the only the slow student a couple of process questions on what this would even look like and like I assume we're not allowed to declare an emergency that would be exciting but I assume that's not something so like how this even like I have some process questions but this actually only the governor and the governor's is conclusive on the topic and let me just weigh in because I understand now that your question was really outside of the accountability system which does create a system of transparency across the Commonwealth that

[03:04:14] we just don't have right now but on top of that your question was what's the VDOE doing what's the administration doing so just a few things that we we have going on we have statewide supports with with our ESSER money as well as with state funding to support to support high dosage tutoring in schools to support our lowest performing schools with greater incentives and bonuses for teacher hiring to support the teacher shortage in critical areas by creating more flexibility as well as alternate pathways to licensure, grants that go directly to families to engage

[03:04:50] in tutoring programs, incentives for schools that do after school weekend and summer programming, as well as resourcing some of those schools better. Internally, we're having conversations about how do we structure, you know, we saw with Florida today, 60% of the school divisions did not get an A rating.

[03:05:13] They got a B or a C and that's a big chunk of them. So we need to restructure our office of school quality to make sure that we're supporting those school divisions and that we are able to deliver the training and the support for their leadership and for their teachers that is just in time and just in the right place to make a difference.

[03:05:37] But we can't do that. If we don't have an accountability, we're gonna constantly be going up against, we're fine. 89% of the schools are fully accredited in the Commonwealth. In fact, we just had a celebration because we're fine and we use the accountability or the accreditation ratings and we're fully accredited.

[03:05:57] And until we have a system that makes more sense, is less nuanced and is very clear to the public in the school divisions that says, this is where your schools are and this is what should drive your school improvement. It's pretty hard to say tutoring, grants, teacher shortage, funding, resourcing, upscale or upskilling of the office of school quality and all of those things are working.

[03:06:23] We can't see those work, those things work unless we have an accountability system that measures, that helps measure some of those, she said. - So what I heard Anne say today was really kind of

the light bulb went off for me because you and I have had these discussions about better resourcing lower performing schools that really need help, right?

[03:06:54] So what she said was an accountability system helps to better identify schools for resource allocation and school improvement needs.

[03:07:10] And if that's the case, I start to think about the kids who get lost in the middle. Well, where are the schools that are getting lost in the middle too, right? Like some of their indicators are lower level, but others of their indicators are high enough to keep them at an accredited level.

[03:07:29] So we're not resourcing those schools because they're meeting the final target, right? And a system of accountability helps to target those resources to, so for example, what she was saying with the English language learners, that's where I see a system of accountability being extremely useful to moving us into a more holistic, better place for all students in the commonwealth not really targeting all of our resources towards what we're seeing from the

[03:08:07] current system as that what 10 of schools that are in that non-accredited area you follow what i'm saying but also you got to dovetail that with the fact that we're still at sort of pre-pandemic funding levels adjusted for inflation right so when we talk about adequate resources i mean you need to have a commitment to fully fund and then adequately resource the remediation.

[03:08:32] I mean, what we're talking about now is shifting around already scarce funds, right? Already inadequate funds, you know, for what purpose? You know, you don't have enough to do what you need to do. And now we're saying, well, if we shine a light on it, you know, we'll allocate the funds we already have that aren't enough in different ways, but you're not really accomplishing the and the purpose you're looking to accomplish.

[03:08:55] If we were, you know, one of the impressive things she said about Florida was, you know, they put resources behind that 60% of the schools. You know, if we had a commitment that we were gonna put resources behind the 60% of the schools that are gonna show up now, you know, on this system, I'd say, let's do this today.

[03:09:13] But we've got a long way to go before, and this is not a new issue for the assembly, right? This is the underfunding, JLARC reports annually, I think, on the status of our funding. I think that's right. I've seen a bunch of them. We're chronically underfunded.

[03:09:30] - And not by a little, you know, by a lot. - Yeah, by a lot. Tammy. - I definitely, I appreciate, Grace, your sense of what the afternoon represented because it triggered for me, we should be calling it something else.

[03:09:47] So I'm definitely aligned there. But I am struggling because I do feel like The decisions that are made here and their flow down to districts, it's going to create an enormous churn that people will have to adjust to.

[03:10:13] And I'm not for not acting on emergency. I'm also just trying to appreciate the context of what these things feel like. At the same time, the literacy piece is going to be implemented and the effort it's going to take to make sure that's done right.

[03:10:29] And I am not opposed to systemic change, but I definitely feel like systemic change that's not approached in a deliberative way serves the potential risk of doing more harm than good.

[03:10:45] And this definitely feels like that. And there's got to be a middle ground. 200, I was looking at the rate of provisionally licensed teachers between 2015 and 2021, increased by 2,205%.

[03:11:07] And what is a provisionally licensed educator? It's someone who's coming in and they don't have the full package, you know, we're going to get them to where they need to be. and and all of those things are necessary but if we could just say for schools that are struggling recruiting because nobody wants to be in a school where they feel like they're not going to be able to move the needle and it's tied to accountability let's let's do what florida did let's say we're going to pay those educators to come out of the woodworks and go spend some time in some of these

[03:11:43] schools where kids have been historically underserved by teachers who don't have and you know the right content training to be there that are using subs, endless because they can't hire, let's put some money right there, right now, because that's going to address the kids that are being impacted by the pandemic right away. I don't understand how this is going to immediately get at that. And again, I find it fascinating to think about moving accreditation aside and focusing on accountability.

[03:12:18] I think that could be a very elegant thing, but why are we accelerating this right now as if that's going to change the struggle that we are facing with this crisis?

[03:12:34] That's the piece I'm struggling with. Yeah, last month we asked for some steps, and your last slide, I know you're still like I've stuck a slide three, shows the number of departments impacted by something like this.

[03:12:55] This is just a window into the complexity here. So again, last month, asking for the steps, which I thought would be of interest, has now moved into this realm of emergency, and this gives me heartburn because anything worth doing is worth doing right, and doing something like this fast is a fraught proposition.

[03:13:20] You know, our next board meeting is not until after the General Assembly is already convened. And so if things are moving very, very fast on the legislative side, then we have a very narrow window of opportunity to try to at least say, here are some of the chunks that should be considered.

[03:13:39] Here are some cornerstones. So, yes, the speed here, wow. So we started the day with Jenna's thing about the Virginia Literacy Act. And the themes we took away from that was systemic thinking and a multi-year approach.

[03:13:56] And these are the ways to do important things well. I take issue with the idea that maybe our system is not transparent. It is transparent. It's just complex. And it's complex on purpose because it's working with really good people in this room and elsewhere.

[03:14:13] We wanted to honor the complexity of the profession. And what we do is incredibly complex. So our system of reporting is very complex. So rather than having the – we got rid of A to F because a one-letter grade oversimplifies the complexity of a school. However, we wanted to move toward consumer reports.

[03:14:31] Over time, we built out this amazing school quality profile and let's put more in. Let's do – oh, we can do this too. And so it has become very complex. So while we need to move back toward clarity, I don't want to completely sacrifice the nuances that we try to capture.

[03:14:48] So with that regard, while personally, as an individual, I do not support a letter grade for a school, the idea of an index, the idea of an index that is weighted, those appeal to me. But I think the under-the-hood work there needs to come back to the board.

[03:15:06] So my hope would be anything that the legislature does about this bifurcation would give back to the board the responsibility for outfitting the vehicle. What if we did this?

[03:15:25] I have a process question. Go ahead and process. It just seems like there's three paths here. One would be we do something the legislature likes that they do conforming legislation. It's done. A second would be they just go ahead. They're going to do something that we're not even aware of because they're looking at this data, too, and are like, there's a problem.

[03:15:45] And then we're responding. Or then third, some sort of hybrid where we give them what Dr. Sieber was just talking about. We give them some ideas. And are there other ways, just in terms of set aside where we all agree or disagree, are there other ways that this potentially plays out that we should be aware of?

[03:16:03] I think so. That's what I was going to suggest, okay? As Dr. Siebert just correctly pointed out, you know, we don't meet again until really the end of the session, right? Middle of the session. Not quite the end. Midway. Not quite crossover.

[03:16:18] But close enough, right. So if there's a legislative package going in, we'll know about that. If the department would draft what they're proposing the regs would look like and have it at our February 1st meeting, that would certainly be helpful in informing us if it's a direction we want to head as a board.

[03:16:38] And we can have the discussion about the merits at that point. You know, right now we're sort of arguing over a bunch of stuff. And I mean, I think, Shelley, correct me on this. I mean, isn't the superintendent required under statute to develop criteria subject to revision by the board isn't that part of that standard it's part of standard three right so if the superintendent actually you know came around and developed the criteria that the superintendent believes be appropriate you know as required by statute for the evaluation of educational performance in the Commonwealth and with a set of proposed

[03:17:14] regs the board would at least have a package of things instead of this sort of amorphous thing you know which we're never going to agree on right we're We're never going to agree without documents in front of us. We can see, Alan, if it meets the standard of honoring the nuance, right?

[03:17:31] We can see if we can get anywhere close to -- it's a complicated process. I mean, part of what, you know, causes me to back up is how many times I've seen the board start something. I mean, it took us hours to do the annual report, right, a document that's got, you know, virtually no importance to anybody except us.

[03:17:51] And I look at the regs and think, geez, this is going to take some time. you know as we've shown we're willing to sit in the chairs for a while you know why doesn't the department go ahead and draft what it is they want us to do uh and let the process continue to see where we are i have more process questions please go ahead how does this work i was joking i know we cannot declare emergency but do we ask the go if we decide collectively as a board do we ask the governor or can he order us no he can't order us the process is and we we did this once under the Northam, I think, administration

[03:18:30] because there was a glitch in the regs dealing with who could graduate down in Southwest. And so a legislator came to us and said, hey, I'm going to put in legislation. We said, you know, we can fix this without legislation. We really don't want to muck the world up.

[03:18:46] And so it was a very narrow issue. It wasn't something as broad as the whole accreditation system, by the way. But we have a letter, which I can find and send to you so you get an idea of what it looks like, where we lay out not only the rationale for what we're doing, exactly what it is we're gonna do, and the fact that we had consent on the board to do it.

[03:19:09] And then we asked Governor Northam to declare an emergency, which under that statute, which allows the emergency reg to go into effect. Under that statute, as I said before, I learned this then, there is no appeal from the governor. The governor, if he declares an emergency, there's no standards either, he can just do it.

[03:19:26] So if he says it's an emergency, then whatever regs we then pass would go into effect immediately. - And outside of the board public comment process, there's no other process for the public to weigh in on emergency regulations. - So I guess, which is another consideration here, I would be loathe to pass a whole new series of accreditation regs without public comment from the field, I mean, geez, it was such a breach of what we do and how we do things.

[03:19:55] But as I said, if the department wants to proceed, why don't we ask for the document they would want us to use and start from there so i'll i'll just weigh in and say that um this is a lot of work and i envision all of us doing it together so to um to think that the department is going to to go down a road to develop a a system or promulgate regs for consideration

[03:20:31] without substantial discussion from this board and without um moving forward together and um and sometimes in tandem where you give us feedback you give us guidance you give us direction and we move forward um that's the way that it should be done not a we haven't had enough conversation about this so come back to us with something and then we'll discuss it because the charge last month was come back with a plan in a timeline which we are placing before you and we are saying

[03:21:04] that the the um the emergency rule making is necessary the legislative changes are necessary to bifurcate the accreditation process and the accountability excuse me the accreditation and the accountability systems there is a sense of urgency there is an education emergency not a a rule-making emergency. It is. That's how it translates. But there is an education emergency that needs to be addressed. We see that in our NAEP scores. We see that in our SOLs. We see that

[03:21:38] in our schools every day. And when we have 89% of our schools that are fully accredited, we aren't seeing every student in the Commonwealth of Virginia. And a new accountability system can help us get there. That is why over the past few months, we've had speakers, we've had staff talking to this board about what does a clearer accountability system look like for the Commonwealth of Virginia and what work should we be embarking on today, tomorrow, next week, next month to make sure that we have an accountability system

[03:22:12] that is less obtuse and more and clarified for our school districts and and more transparent for our school districts beginning in the 23-24 school year and the more that we can have a discussion versus come back to us with a work product and then we'll have a discussion that's that's we we don't have time to

do that and this is the emergency and dr ballo we've been looking at a lot of slides today if there's if i so i may be misremembering in the

[03:22:46] the the deck for this presentation which we i'm sorry i've completely hijacked um uh there was a proposal that we do some kind of a virtual meeting midwinter or am i mixing that up with a different deck that is possible we put that in there as a placeholder um making sure that we can continue this discussion and that two two months doesn't go by i mean that that's not fair to do to school divisions either if we're not able to advance this conversation until february when we come back with a work product that that my hunch is there will be lots of feedback lots of input

[03:23:20] We've got to have a few things going at the same time with this work to ensure that the board is engaged in the process, school divisions are engaged in the process, and VDOE is engaged in the process. To your point, though, I mean, I have to say that so last month we had the presentation by what was the Dr. Hovannitz, and that's when some of us were pretty, you know, bowled over by some some of either the proposals and in today's accountability um uh presentation by uh

[03:23:59] high slope and high slope um and to your point about um it being obtuse and less transparent that's exactly how when i start to look at all of this it's just and that's what we said last month that this is all just so so murky hard to understand and not transparent that um at the cost of at the risk of sounding uh rash i would say why not give it a shot why i mean why why do

[03:24:33] we have to be so slow to respond this is after all something uh it is um it is a matter of emergency on many levels so i i would definitely uh vote for something that gives more transparency more actual accountability um way for us to parents to better understand so i would definitely support this at some point the board needs to actually deal with the details we have not been very good

[03:25:09] at original drafting at the board level which is why i asked the department to give us something to respond to right because you clearly have an idea what you want it to look like at the end and it would be helpful to use that as the starting point for where we're headed if you ask us i mean we could sit here for days talking about all the various features of various accountability systems and make no progress all i'm looking for is something to actually respond to to refine to get this thing going along a path that you know you guys wanted to go along you know i don't think

[03:25:47] that's that was an unreasonable you know concept in order to keep a time frame moving that seems to be in concert with what you want to do i mean miss creasy's motion which was really made after mr rotherham uh said let's just issue an aura i mean it's like well no i mean but that's what you said right you said let's go ahead and do this and it's like well we don't exactly know what we're going to do. And I think it's more complicated because I believe that we needed legislative support. And so we asked the department to come back with not a timeline, but the steps

[03:26:22] that were necessary to split the two systems. And now we understand that we need not only the board to act in terms of approving regulation, but we need the legislature to act in terms of changing the code. And so that's a very helpful thing. But, you know, I mean, I'm prepared to sit here all night, but I'm not sure everybody else is, to talk about all the various permutations of the different systems that were just laid out. Without something to respond to,

[03:26:52] this is going to be an endless project. Present. Yes, sir. So, again, I just want to, this is kind of like the pool of dialogue where ideas can go in, and so I just want to throw it there. I think there's

something in between emergency and moving slow, and I think, you know, again, just probably haven't been around Public Education Virginia for a long time, having seen changes play out in the Commonwealth in the past, I think that in between emergency and slow, there is urgent. And I think one way to take some pressure off this conversation is to say, you know, okay, we want an index,

[03:27:32] we want it weighted, we want it designed by BOE, we want implementation in 24-25. That still means that 23-24, we report out where people would fall on both systems. This is what we've done in the past when we've changed accountability credits. We've shown this is where you are in this rule book. This is where you are on this rule book. And that would be an opportunity, I think, to be more thoughtful. Still, you know, get the ball moving rapidly. It has to be built. But I just think that they're saying that this is going to be in effect for 23-24, I think creates a pressure that's going

[03:28:09] to make it hard to bring people to the table, to have thoughtful conversations. And again, we risk this is so important it needs to be done right um that's my concern mrs chrissy i have a question for staff i know you guys are sitting over there so quietly and nicely um my question for you is are we certain that that what you all have looked at as far as essentially changing the verbiage from accreditation to accountability is as easy as that or do we know or do we do we even know

[03:28:48] whether some of that would increase the likelihood of substantial changes needed in some of the language do you understand what i'm asking i don't think we meant to imply that any of it would be easy there are some places where accreditation just could be replaced with accountability but because the verbiage accreditation is throughout the code it would be a tedious process so it's not we didn't mean to imply it would be easy to do and i mean i think dr siebert reflected that

[03:29:27] there are places in the soq that actually describe what accreditation is to be so we did not mean to imply that it would be an easy change and i don't know if my colleagues want to add anything i thought you were going to ask a different question as crazy for the like and this is i think for you dr ballo but also for you dr loving writer like this is a lot of work and i think the conforming changes are actually the more straightforward piece like the design pieces of like figuring out how these things would work it's very com like do you feel like if we were to move on to an expedited

[03:30:04] timeline to get this done in time for so we could actually use it for the next school year does that seem i mean dr ballo you can commit that we have the the resource because people have other things on their plate and so forth as well and we do after this is measure twice and cut once for sure yeah for sure i i appreciate that analogy and um i know uh shelley will uh will want to weigh in on this as well but internally we we don't have the expertise or the capacity to do all of this work but we've identified our partners nationally and in the commonwealth who can help us with some of

[03:30:41] this work um as um i think shelley noted this is this is not easy work um and and in the olden days it would have been great to have five or seven years to redesign an accountability system it doesn't really take that long but um we we we have great models across the nation we have great partners across the nation we have great thinkers within the commonwealth and with and on this dais and um and within the department of education who are ready to move this forward and have the

[03:31:16] resources to to tap into to do that but but it is incumbent on on our ability to move forward together on this work so why don't we bring forward the models that you think are the good models nationally yeah I mean we we did that's that's nice Florida is Florida what your your model is well or no

Xcel and Ed brought brought forth several models Florida was one of them but it's certainly one that we can we can build off of and today we heard a much more

[03:31:50] generic hopefully complementary presentation that says these are these are the important things what I would hope that we embark on as a board is a discussion about here's here's what we know is working in other states how do we use the components that we heard from Ann and that we have researched and maybe that are within our accountability system right now to create Virginia's accountability system um going forward and um and so you know we'll continue to take that information

[03:32:25] but um you know it won't be a a study for two years that that we do so mr mr president please so three things i heard miss hyslop say one you just don't want to do this without robust collaboration among the partners who are going to be affected by it the stakeholders and and the legislators.

[03:32:51] And that doesn't have to take two years, but it's hard to see how it can be done on the timeline that you've outlined. Number two, she said, the metrics that go into, you know, it's not just saying, okay, we're gonna have an A through F system or an index.

[03:33:09] We gotta decide which of our many current indicators are gonna go into it and how they're gonna be weighted. So that's a substantive set of choices that has major implications. And we would want, I mean, I would wanna hear, for instance, well, if we do this kind of waiting system, how many schools is that gonna put into A, B, C, D, or F approximately, and do we have the resources at the Office of School Quality to address them, and what's gonna be our intervention mode?

[03:33:37] So, you know, there's a lot of devil in the details. And then the third I heard from her that I would want to understand somewhat upfront, and the third thing I heard from her is that resources, accompanying resources is absolutely crucial. so my my for what it's worth my my free unsolicited advice to the advocates for changing the system would be if there is i will be shocked i'm i'm way too smart to predict what the legislature will do but i will say this i would be shocked if the legislature will adopt will authorize a wholesale

[03:34:14] change without knowing the devil in these details so i don't know how you're going to get these bills through without telling the legislature what kind of weighted index you're going to be using for whatever this system is and we know they rejected an a through f before so what is the weighted index and and that's going to have to be on the table you know before january and we're going to have to have input into that somehow that has to fit into the timeline and we're going to have to have a whole lot of study and feedback from you all to help us get you know we're going to have to have some information about the implications for the different weightings

[03:34:50] that we're you know if the resource piece the governor introduces his proposed budget i think in three weeks four weeks you know if there are several hundred i mean my little back of the envelope calculation which i'm sure is woefully inadequate simply on what's it going to take to do mr rotherham you referred to the teacher incentives that dc did if we do a teacher incentive program to get teachers into our high poverty schools uh my back of the envelope calculation is we're talking several hundred million dollars a year and and i i do see that the governor's revenue estimates just came out and we're flush we continue to be flush so if the

[03:35:26] governor's uh introduced budget on december 16th has several hundred million dollars for for teacher incentives for the petersburgs and and richmond's of the world you're going to see uh legislators

more interested in this but it's not you know the the timing is is we we we can't we can't just tell the legislature oh we want to change the whole we want to do a wholesale challenge change in the accountability system you all passed this bill letting us do it and by the way we'll tell you what all the details are in a march rate i i don't i don't think that's what what anyone's insinuating

[03:36:00] the um the proposals that that we would make this year are not changes that we again we would move forward together but um if there is a clear desire to bifurcate accreditation from accountability those would be the asks for this year and um and and you know there there are also some different scenarios that i think would it would be the board to have conversations about that we've talked about internally certainly um overlaying an accountability system with our current accreditation

[03:36:31] system um for you know for a period of time and um so we would we would be figuring both perhaps i think that there are some some additional conversations to be had to move this forward mr president can i ask one more thing while we've got the staff here so the hb 938 committee's task force's mandate included looking at many of these issues and i understand there is a report from them that that's we've appointed a large group of a task force of folks with expertise

[03:37:07] in the field to look at this and understand there is a draft report the sooner we can get that the the better, the little bit I've heard from people who were in those meetings is there was a sentiment that we shouldn't rush in any of this, that there's a lot of complexity to it and that getting the devil in the details right is incredibly important.

[03:37:29] And while there was sentiment that there was a benefit to more transparency, that there were risks involved if you did it willy-nilly and without a careful look. and and that there was if i understood again correctly and i don't mean to speak for those of you who were there but that there was sentiment against changing drastic changes in the cut store there was a sentiment against um um uh taking growth uh down downplaying the effect of growth certainly one of the very important metrics we hear from this haslott today is the balance of

[03:38:07] growth versus proficiency something as fundamental as that you know i don't know how we have any sense What's going on until we hear some of those do take details, right? And we've heard those over the last couple of months we heard him just in the last presentation. We heard him last month as well from Christy Hovannis from Excel and Ed and we'll continue to hear more about those here about them But we haven't heard what the proposal is no that's you know But it but it is in this board's authority to establish an accountability system that is not a statutory change it is this board has the authority to establish the accountability

[03:38:44] system and we have we just call it accreditation and you don't like it and i get that you don't like it and i get there may be ways to improve it i agree there are ways to improve it and that's what we're trying to move forward on have you sorry did you i was just i apologize work commitment that took me away for a few minutes but i i just for context would like to know what motion is on the table so i can there's no motion it's a discussion thank you the motion will be much more animated and the presentation sadly is staff trying to we let them get to slide two of their

[03:39:18] deck and then we hijacked them i had a couple questions so um the um board discusses the necessity of emergency regulations for new accountability when what what is if this is just a presentation there's nothing to take an action today when what is being um asked here as far as emergency regulations when would that kick in like today if we no no um we you know what what

[03:39:53] we've what we've asked for is for um this board to move forward with um a letter to the governor requesting emergency rulemaking authority and assuming that he would grant that that would give the board flexibility to then have um you know perhaps a presentation between a work session a virtual work session between this board meeting and the next board meeting to have some discussions about exactly some of the details that that you're thinking about we would engage our national partners in helping to um to to put recommendations forward to this board so that in february it's a

[03:40:33] little more fleshed out than it would be if if we don't have some direction and some opportunity to work between between now in February and then there is a is there is an action today right in this not today there I mean there there could be tomorrow the letter but I you know that that's that's something that the board needs to decide and discuss today no then tomorrow or tomorrow or not at it depends if there's emotion and and have you engaged with these partners national and

[03:41:07] state partners on actually getting the ball rolling yeah i mean you know we we we have of course um you know as as a state chief for um for now oh my goodness almost eight years um in wyoming in here um i i've worked on a a an overhaul or a rewrite of a federal accountability system under essa a statewide accountability after essa changes to the statewide accountability uh system in wyoming to include college career and military readiness and value that the same

[03:41:42] as we did our advanced courses and um so you know i i i have a a pretty wide network and an understanding as does our staff who has also been through accreditation and accountability work of of who we need to reach out to for things like looking through our regulations to find out what changes exactly need to be made, bringing forth recommendations for a new accountability system.

[03:42:08] Certainly, we heard from Excel and Ed, and certainly they would be a key partner that we would engage. That's the work that they do, but we would engage others as well. - So again, in terms of bringing this to some kind of closure, I think we can still move the ball along if the department is willing to come back either with an outline of the system you'd like to see in place, which I think is not unreasonable to ask, and if it's possible at the same time the proposed regs.

[03:42:46] I mean, the declaration, the letter for the declaration, you know, can go any time during this process 'cause as soon as the governor signs it, it's done. It is difficult for me to conceive of writing a letter asking for an emergency declaration, when I have no idea what it is, I'm gonna be asking, you know, the regs.

[03:43:04] We just haven't done it that way before. I'm uncomfortable with the idea of asking the governor for carte blanche on this. And I think we're required to lay out what it is we wanna do. So that piece doesn't hold you up at all. When do you think, and I appreciate that you said, you know, yeah, we heard these things, but I mean, what we really heard was Florida's got a system and very broad outlines.

[03:43:26] We didn't hear any of the specifics of the system. know in fairness and what it really looks like in legislative terms and are there nuances there are there pieces of it that we ought to be aware of when do you think the department and your outside consultants can put something together that the board can react to let's let's turn it back over to staff because i think that's on a slide that's coming up oh sorry i had assumed the slideshow is out of the window by now nope while they're finding it can i ask uh is miss high slop from

[03:44:00] All for Ed one of your national partners or could we consider her for one? I was very impressed with I she was amazing And I think we absolutely should consider her as a partner and you know, it takes it takes expertise from across the education field when we start talking about proficiency scores when we start talking about Assessment align you know and and some of those are after the fact, but there there are a lot of partners There's not one person or even one team that we engage in this process process, it's a lot and it's across the board.

[03:44:30] I think she'd be probably happy to help just because she's a good citizen and potentially more if we could. But the most important thing I think she said that we should underscore is I think there's a straw man of what we should do in Florida or Indiana. I think the most important thing she said is we need to design a system for Virginia because we have our own context and we can learn.

[03:44:50] And I think historically one of our problems has been not going around and learning, but can't fall into this trap that you see an education where people go to Finland and decide they like something and bring it back with no context about Finland and it's the same thing so my only concern i'm pretty comfortable with moving because i think we'll be here in a year having the same conversations if we don't is just the amount of work this will be because it would be easier if there was some state and we said let's just like do their thing and so just like where we're taking the conversation now i think we should just have no illusions about the amount of work to get this

[03:45:24] right and the consequences if we don't get it right agree and if if if it was even possible or plausible to say i like that system let's adopt that then everyone in the nation would be you know it would be whittled down to two or three systems it's not that way every system of of education governance and definition of student success and outcomes is a little bit different And so we do need to take that time and I'm going to turn it back to staff, hopefully uninterrupted, to talk through this.

[03:45:59] You're drafting the regs. I want you to draft anyway, right? That's what it says up there. It says you're already doing it. I don't know why we have such pushback on this. I mean, it's only November 16th. We didn't say that. I'm going to give it a specific date. In my world, that means it's already done. It does. And the letter for rulemaking, you know, perhaps it's a governor's preference or not.

[03:46:20] But it formally kicks off a process and I think tips our hat to our commitment as a board and as a department that we are dedicated to this work. Okay.

[03:46:41] I'm confused where we are. I think we have an understanding now, right? We're going to come back at the next meeting and we're going to have more. I will say, and I appreciate the concept of the emergency, although then you seem to back off of the need for that some, I would be incredibly uncomfortable as a board member telling the 122 I guess it is now since one can solve divisions how many divisions now 132 excuse me that we are going to implement regs without a reasonable public input process I'll tell you that right now I just cannot imagine this

[03:47:18] board taking an area this important and frankly after hearing the speakers that were brought in to say to them say to every division we're changing the rules And we're not going to ask you anything about it in a formal process. I just can't do that I mean, I guess I will if the board does it, but you know what I'm saying. Yeah, and that's that's not the way it works Well, it is the way it works if you we have no public hearings Well, is that those the table stakes we keep hearing we'd be able to involve the public even on this expedite timeline Okay, I don't want to do a process that formally could exclude the public. I appreciate that I don't think anyone does.

[03:47:55] Okay, then the emergency then would not be the route to go. No. The emergency rulemaking process does not have public engagement built into the process. But we could still do it, right? And you move simultaneously with the regular rulemaking process that absolutely has public input.

[03:48:12] And we could do just because it's not required doesn't mean we couldn't. For sure. We can absolutely add that. It would not meet this timeline if I'm being frank with you. mean this is an incredibly expedited timeline and I think it would be a challenge to meet what we've laid out here you know again certainly there would be public engagement at the board meeting but to add in additional public hearings you know in between January February March especially as you're also doing the same thing on the history standards I think would be a challenge just to give the constituent groups time to respond we don't we don't we

[03:48:48] We won't have a draft until February, so how do we give people time to respond to that in a meaningful way? How do we give VAS and all the other folks? And so I think that -- Female Speaker: But wouldn't it be a different team from the history and social sciences standards? We do have different teams who could -- Female Speaker: Sure, but the board's engaged in that process in all of the public hearings.

[03:49:08] Female Speaker: What do you mean by public hearings? Female Speaker: The public hearings that the board holds, you all are the ones that are at the public hearing. Male Speaker: The public common period. Male Speaker: No, no, no. The board is required, before we adopt standards of learning, to hold public hearings as the department decided to, in addition to the board's mandated public hearings, to do listening sessions on their own, which is fine and a good practice, right, so that's a good thing.

[03:49:35] But even we could not finalize those standards without going to public comment, that's in the statute. But we farm ourselves out for those. And public comment does not mean here, public comment means we will hold a separate public hearing in locations and for this my guess is five locations around the state which which we go to which different board members will chair i mean we'll look for volunteers to chair them and receive the public comment uh on the more complicated ones we've actually had a third party reporting service there to consolidate i can't remember the last one we did like that we when we did a listening tour

[03:50:14] um on the standards of quality yeah you know what i'm talking about yeah yeah so i mean it is there's a formal required process that's different from public comment here we have to go to public hearing and you know it seems to me on something this large you know you know for folks who pride themselves on transparency etc etc right you know we ought to be listening to the public in a formal setting and you know i would intend to do that did you say that that could happen in parallel well it can't happen until the drafts are done because the public has nothing to respond to

[03:50:54] right right there's a difference between doing something with people and doing something to people i also think there's a difference between one year and four to five years and and that's where to and and you're thinking of measure twice and cut once there the two in there for me is the year to build it model show what it shows while we're using what we're using and then refine tweak and come back and so i i think this can be done but here's just an example i mean we're about to embark we've been embarking on history standards for a chunk of time and it's taken a long long time so so at this macro level the presentation we had last month trees we just had very exciting

[03:51:30] macro level possibilities but for just one just one example in there and it's going to activate some ptsd i have and probably shelly too the student growth percentile piece um so so if you say we're

going to wait we have an index and we're going to weight it and and the weights must include these five factors even if the board gets to choose what the weights are one of those weights what decides well how much is achievement versus growth and then well that how are you going to measure growth and oh you're going to measure growth using student growth percentiles well we we've got you know court action going back seven years ago about just how foia would release the results of those student growth percentiles i mean so it is a incredibly fraught process very

[03:52:09] complex very difficult still absolutely worth doing but um you know i i just if we're going to get behind the wheel of this car and start driving it then we've got to manage the speed so that there's not collateral damage would the ptsd go down go away if it's drawn out over two years um two years again a year to build it thoughtfully with the people in the commonwealth of virginia who have been asking for a modernization of assessment accountability for years there's enthusiasm and desire to do this to do it in an emergency fashion rather than an urgent fashion

[03:52:48] would squash the opportunity to really capitalize on that enthusiasm about doing this right and doing this well and i'm not talking about doing over four or five years but i say to try to say this is going to be in place for school year 23 24 i get the the enthusiasm about that um i just i just question the wisdom of it and i'm afraid we could just just lose everything that we could accomplish i think you could absolutely build it in the coming year that way we get authorization the general assembly this year to get started on it we begin building it we come back in the next session get you know get whatever other pieces we need done and uh and you've built it thoughtfully

[03:53:27] and at the end of next school year you can still report both our current credits and in the meantime please know serving in a in an urban district community eligibility provision high poverty our current system works our matrix showing every square for every school what's yellow what's green and what's red has absolutely driven school-based planning there's already a sense of urgency about the learning loss all that is is happening um and we were doing uh science-based reading before we were required to so there's some good data coming from that but i think to hurry these things um i just it's too important okay so i i think we're talking over each other as i listen to you dr

[03:54:07] siebert we we do realize that next year is a test run where we run both accountability and accreditation and that the implementation year slide errors slide 10 8 of 8 the new accreditation and accountability systems are used in accountability year 24 25 and the current system will no longer be used so the new accountability system will be stood up for 2023 2024 and used simultaneously with the current accreditation system so we will figure both then why do you need the emergency regs process i just don't get it because it it it needs to it needs to be in place even a year not

[03:54:46] Not to simply calculate the numbers as an example. You can calculate the numbers any way you want to calculate them and put them out there. That one follow up to Allen's point about I never, I still don't understand student growth percentiles, but I do remember when we went through the last major revision to the accountability accreditation slash accountability system, there was a lot of talk about SGPs and I still don't understand it, but I do remember from that talk that there were people who thought we would be better off using student growth percentiles

[03:55:26] instead of what we've got for growth, and that there were difficulties with implementing that with our Virginia data system. I'm way oversimplifying it, and Shelly could take an hour and explain it to

us, or maybe even give us a short version of it, But my impression is, if we wanna do student growth percentiles, it's gonna take at least a little time to figure out how to do it.

[03:55:53] I mean, our system, we're not a state with a Smarter Balanced test or a park test. So to figure out how to jam our whole testing system was built around proficiency, not growth, and we've sort of jerry-rigged it to do growth.

[03:56:09] And it's gotten better and better over time, thanks to hard work from Shelly and colleagues as a growth measure, but I don't think that doing SGP is now gonna be easy unless I'm missing something. - If I may respond, Mr. Garrett.

[03:56:24] - You were correct. I think the issues with student growth percentiles will still occur in Virginia. And we were one of the first states to use them. We actually used them under the RO days when we were required to create a growth measure. The difficulty we encountered was because of the acceleration we allow, we could have a fifth grade student who's taking the seventh grade math test.

[03:56:50] And so to create the growth percentile, you're comparing that student only to the other students, the fifth grade students who took the seventh grade math test. And you're determining that student's growth measure based on the comparison to only the fifth grade students who took the seventh grade math test.

[03:57:08] So we ended up having a situation where we really weren't able to adequately show growth for advanced students. And you may remember, Ms. Holton, that we eventually decided we weren't going to calculate the SGPs for the advanced students, which seems to fly in the face of what Ann Husslott was saying.

[03:57:27] So I will-- So if we are going to try to meet this timeline, we should consider using measures that we have already. Trying to do student growth percentiles would take a significant amount of time.

[03:57:46] We worked on them for about 18 months the last time with one staff member almost completely dedicated to that project. So if there's interest in student growth percentiles, that might be something to consider down the road, but we may want to consider something that we have in place already, at least for the interim.

[03:58:05] - And I suggest that simply as Alan did, One example of the level of complexities of decisions that this group needs to make and and I'm all for Trying to do them on an urgent basis as Alan says, but not on an emergency basis and truly I clarify the this this eight slide eight of eight Dr. Baylor, thank you very much Does help because what I obviously misunderstood early on was having this in place for 2324 It will be but it won't count But it won't be if we don't go if we if we don't start the process if we don't have the accountability system, then it truly is doing something to someone

[03:58:45] because it's the department saying this is what we think is best and we've had the board weigh in on it and we want to give schools a practice year but we're not sure that it's, we haven't gone through the rulemaking process or the formal process. So that doesn't even make sense to do that.

[03:59:03] But in terms of designing the system, your schedule is to have that done by March or April. I mean, yeah, to deciding what weight, what kind of, are we going to do a weighted index, or are we going to do A through F, and what are we going to weight in the index, and how are we going to deal with N sizes,

and how are we going to deal with English language learners, all of that will have to be finalized by this board by March or April on an emergency regs basis per your system.

[03:59:28] july august september and october um we are working on our consolidated you know what i'm going to turn to staff you guys know where this is yeah yes if yeah if if we were to stick with first review would be in february so what's the pushback on asking for what it's going to look like in february i'm still mr i mean it seems to be i'm asking for exactly the same timeline that you guys are saying we're going to do yeah so how come we're pushing back i'm not what who's pushing back you said how can I possibly draft this without the board's input and what

[04:00:08] I'm saying is on your timeline we're gonna have regs for first review in February if I may I think the difference is there would be that January virtual work session where we get more input from you we don't have a January work session scheduled yet I see right but that was that was in the timeline that we didn't talk about so in one virtual work session we're expected to iron out all the nuances of the proposed new system have regs drawn by February 1 for first review and final review in March is that the concept we we thought about yeah and we did think about a March first review and and I push back a

[04:00:46] little bit on that because I want to give school divisions as much time as possible with this as well and so you know we can that that's a place where I think we could adjust because I also think this is where we do need some kind public engagement with this that's meaningful um and so is and i and what emily said earlier i think should carry a fair amount of weight just in terms of the ability to execute that kind of input and

[04:01:17] so yeah execute the receiving of it so yeah i mean really i i think mostly of um mostly of school divisions on this and just making sure that they have adequate time to to think about it and prepare for even a practice year remember next year would be a practice year with a new system but giving them as much time as possible would be would be key is it possible to have the first review in march yeah i think we could we could make that adjustment we do have a meeting in march

[04:01:55] correct we do we're february march and april so that gives an opportunity for two more discussions on one full work session um that we we could schedule in january if that's the the will of the board and then a february discussion um to give input and you know i i think you can spend there there's a risk of spending too little time having a discussion about some of the the finer points and some of the details of an accountability system um but there's also a risk in in drawing

[04:02:30] that out and doing hours and hours and hours of multiple multiple um partners potential partners or going you know we we've really tried to tried to winnow that that work down for everyone a little bit um but if there are other things that this board wants to see we can absolutely bring that forward um i'm i'm never a fan of of sort of drafting from the dais i want to make sure that we have conversations um and and that we come to you with the subject matter experts so that you can give us direction and um and we can move forward but i have to say i'm not i'm not clearly

[04:03:09] hearing that from this from from the consensus of the board today and i i want to make sure that um you know that that we're not going through the exercise of um of drafting this on on a fast and urgent timeline um quickly and carefully but urgent and uh and and then the board decides that no we're not going to act on it and and i'm not sure that that that's the sentiment but i guess

[04:03:37] said like some reassurance that it isn't and for me it'll be dependent on seeing the governor's budget proposal frankly I mean if there's resources in here that are going to help the DF schools once they're labeled DF then we're in a completely different ballgame and if we're not then I'm gonna I'm I don't know how i could i could i'm not going to do something that's going to make it harder for

[04:04:13] petersburg to hire teachers yep mr gecker if i may i think something that would be helpful to staff is to have some indication of which indicators you want to keep and which ones you want to change and superintendent bale i'm saying that because there's so much data work that has to be done um in order to come up with what would really be the the new system um go ahead i'm sorry i thought you were finished i'm sorry no so if we could have some guidance at some point about what you all want to keep as far as indicators and what you might want to change that would be helpful

[04:04:54] i think it would be helpful to me i'll say that because the rest of these folks are much more astute at this to understand on each of the indicators what your professional view is about what we ought to be doing i mean there's nobody in the country who knows more about this than you do and you know it would help me a lot to understand where you are on the various indicators waiting systems etc i mean you've seen everything that's gone on in the country for a number of years i won't say how many but a lot and it's you know i'm not saying that you know you or staff gets

[04:05:34] final call that's not what i'm suggesting but at least you know you know unlike andy who also sees a lot of this you know i don't get this in my daily life i want to understand what you view as the pros and cons much like this has still played out you know here are the pros and cons of these various things you know hard for me to tell in a vacuum and so uh i'm not looking to put work more work on you guys but and i don't know if anybody else on the board feels that way but having the the professional guidance of staff in this regard would be tremendously helpful, at least to me.

[04:06:09] - I would echo that. - It's not to punt it, but it's a serious request for we're swimming upstream here for me. - That would be a great thing to have at the work session. And the other thing I would love to have, I saw that you recommended Jillian and/or Emily send out an email offering everybody the opportunity to hear Kent Dickey's Finance 101 in Virginia.

[04:06:31] It is a great presentation. I've heard it two or three times and I still learn something new every time. And because the money and how it's expended and how we resource our schools at both the state and federal, state, federal and local level is so intertwined with all of this that if we could get Kent to do that presentation for the whole board sooner rather than later, it would be great.

[04:06:59] - Yeah, I am looking forward to that. We're getting that scheduled. I am in a slightly different place. I think it's just important to serve some of the different perspectives. I do think this qualifies as a crisis for Virginia, just given the data we've seen. So I'm comfortable with the caveats that we have to get this right and be able to engage the public.

[04:07:17] I am not, I mean, I'd like to see more investment in schools. I think we probably all have different things we'd like to see, but I'm not comfortable like saying like we can't move forward on accountability until we get the money right. And that's probably me. I've just done this a long time and I've been through so many rounds of we're going to be ready for accountability just as soon as the resources are there. I feel like Charlie Brown, because Lucy is always yanking that football away. And I just think we have the order of operations.

[04:07:43] I mean, we can do them in tandem, or we can have the order of operations that by creating a good, honest, transparent accountability system that really is responsive, that's how we can build the will to address things that I think a lot of us agree on with disequities in our finance system and so forth. But I see this as sort of a predicate for addressing that, and we're never going to get there. So I'm hopeful. I'd like to see that too, but I don't feel in any way this needs to be contingent on a bunch of stuff that we simply can't control.

[04:08:13] Andy, I agree. And I do think this is an emergency. I think when the governor spoke after the NAEP results came out, he talked about more resources. I am assuming the budgets going to have more resources this is also 24 25 so there's going to be a couple bites at the apple depending on how all this comes out for to support whatever needs to be out there but i feel like the kids need this our system needs this and if our superintendent is saying that she can rally

[04:08:46] the troops and the agency to get this done i frankly think it is on us to move forward and to take that same act of urgency to address the emergency that is um that our students are facing and we've seen the statistics at the last meeting from excellence ed we saw them again today of our drop of where we are and i just um and these are numbers but behind the numbers of the reality of the kids and especially our most disadvantaged kids and i just think that we need to do whatever

[04:09:23] we can as a board, as an agency, to get out there and to get these wheels in motion and waiting another year, in my mind, is not an option. And I think it was you that mentioned the cohort today. You know, it's, you know, we might have had a blip or whatever we talked about in the prior presentation, but we still have a lag of kids and we have a system that um i think needs to be improved and i think parents businesses everybody that's involved in this process need to have a better understanding better clarity of what we're dealing with

[04:10:01] and we can't fix the problems until we know the diagnosis is and know where the challenges are we can direct our resources to and the sooner we can get that done in my mind the better off we're going to be because if we wait another year or two of where we're going to prioritize our resources i think it's a shame on us yeah i would like to echo what mr rothrahan said and uh well said um i think with virginia students bottom scoring the bottom most in the country it's definitely a matter of urgency and um and i i think we have the momentum that that's one thing i think there there is not only the sense of urgency but there's also

[04:10:41] the momentum and i think you will be able to take advantage of that and i i do feel that parents definitely want to see what what what does accountability mean i mean when i go to my local school division and students are not faring well but yet you say oh it's all well fine and dandy that's not acceptable to parents so i'd like to just to be clear we did not score lowest in the nation the statistic that they use the fact that they use is we've met our standards our SOL standards map lowest in the nation which is much different our performance on the NAEP was not at the bottom of the nation we're not arguing

[04:11:21] that I'm arguing that just not arguing I'm just saying we're about it for us to say we're the worst in the nation is a different thing I meant the biggest drop in the nation yes no I just we have people here I have an idea I just don't like it out there. I have an idea. Maybe I'm a staff and Superintendent Baylow for this next work session to give us a framework that we can all kind of connect to. Last month, you know, we heard that, you know, here are the nine elements of an accountability system. People are going to argue

[04:11:54] me about number one, whether that's a letter grade or stars or index, but, you know, items two through nine, you know, or people had common ground or in general. So maybe that could be a starting point for you all how how you you what virginia has available um what how would we meet items two through nine um and and what we and in that again i think i think we need to be very honest that if we can't do growth well right now with our coolant tools we put an asterisk next to that and we say the next time we have an rfp for an assessment system we'll be seeking something you know superior

[04:12:32] but what would be the bones based on that approach and so that might help us move the conversation forward i think the other thing is that i liked i don't necessarily know it was in in today's presentation but the idea of the quadrant chart where we how how do you show a high achieving high growth school versus a low achieving high growth school versus a low achieving low growth school you know what what would be again because we get this this growth piece is going to be very problematic for us you know what would be the way we could do that sort of out of the gate and then and what would be the considerations we would need to have longer term to do it better.

[04:13:08] I don't, that might be a structure of sort of a next action. - Mr. President, last comment for me tonight, six o'clock. Again, I just want to underscore how important it feels to acknowledge that when there are differences of opinion about the strategy that's going to get us to the shared goal we all have of wanting to see children in the commonwealth succeed that it's not about we don't see the emergency i really feel

[04:13:42] very strongly about how easy it can be to care to have the public misunderstand what the shared commitments are of people who volunteer their time and their energy to serve in these roles not easy work a lot of work and i gotta believe that everybody that sits around this table regardless of who they were appointed by are here because they're committed and that they

[04:14:13] do under we do i understand very much what's at stake i'm on the ground every day in my community and see firsthand how difficult it is to get people in schools i do and so i i do hope that as we engage in this discourse around what's the best strategy that we really try and measure the importance of we have different opinions about the most expedient way to get to the end result

[04:14:48] that we all share but we're all committed to wanting to see children succeed um i've had to really work through a fair bit of self-management as we're having conversations about what is most urgent and when i think about the kinds of things that we have made commitments to do in the very short time that we've had the benefit of having a full board seated some things have had to take the back seat that have felt very urgent in regards to investments that others have made

[04:15:22] and i've had to settle with that and so i want to make sure that there's there is measured consideration for what that can feel like measure consideration for what that can feel like lab schools complete faith that what was desired was going to happen even though we don't really fully understand how that's going to be sustained but there was a commitment to support and so

[04:16:01] it's been a struggle because i don't want to see politics ruin how important it is to be above that when it comes to the task before us so that was heavily on my mind appreciate that i think we are done uh i think staff understands where we are and if not we'll fill in the gaps tomorrow or

[04:16:35] the next day yeah somebody's got to but you know we're going to need something to respond to as a board i don't think that's unreasonable uh i would like advice of staff you know i don't think that's

unreasonable either as to what we're doing and you know obviously uh i hope and although i didn't hear it that there's a commitment to making this process as public as it ought to be for the benefit of the commonwealth i mean there we go we are adjourned enjoy your dinner



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